COACHING

ESSENTIALS

Meta-Coaching System®

Module I

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

Coaching Essentials: Module I — Meta-Coaching

Coaching Essentials
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Disclaimer:

This Training Manual is designed for *training and education* and should not be used as a substitute for psychotherapy or psychiatry. Even though this material was designed and written by a psychologist and a Professional Licensed Counselor in the State of Colorado, USA, Dr. Hall and the International Society of Neuro-Semantics (ISNS) recommend that if psychological and psychiatric assistance is needed, that it should be sought by those professionally certified to give it and that this manual should not be considered a substitute.

META-NLP

SYNOPSIS OF THE TRAINING

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Opening Agreements
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Detecting Meta-Programs
Meta-Program Mastery
Meta-Program Exercises
Pattern:
Changing Meta-Programs

DAY 1:

Agenda for Day 1:

- Introduce the basic *NLP Communication Model* and *the Meta-Programs Model.*
- Discover how communication goes through the human perceptual filters.
- Identify the basic meta-programs needed to effectively learn and use the NLP Model.

- Discover the *languages* of the mind— the Representational Systems.
- Discover how to read and detect the sensory systems.
- Begin to develop the art of active listening for the structure of a person's experience.

- Discover the process for calibrating to another person's experience.
- Learn the editorial level of representing — the cinematic features of the mind.
- Discover the magical art of gaining rapport through pacing.
- Play with the pattern of Perceptual Positions to expand personal flexibility.

Orientation Questions for Beginning the Day:

- What do you want to learn and discover today?
- What skills and competencies do you want to develop or refine?
- As you consider the outcomes from this day, set two or three that will be important to you.
- What state do you want to induce yourself into as you begin the adventure today?

Opening Frames for the Training

As you study NLP, there are several ways to consider yourself, perhaps as a "magician in training" (using the magic of language), or a modeler of human excellence, or as a professional communicator. Whatever you decide, this study is about communication— first self-communication in running your own brain and managing your own states. Then communicating to others to create win/win relationships. As we invite you into this cognitive-behavioral science and art, here are a set of questions to consider as your part and responsibility for getting all that you can from this training.

___ Will you agree to take full ownership for your own brain and state as you engage in this study?

___ Will you agree to enter this study for the single focus of learning, discovering, and applying these processes and principles for your own growth and personal development?

___ Will you set yourself to look for and get as much value from the training for yourself?

___ Will you seek to support and contribute value to others in the training?

___ Will you focus on learning the patterns and processes to gain competency and therefore certification as an NLP Practitioner?

___ Will you agree to be on time for the sessions and to be time-conscious of the breaks, beginning and ending times?

___ Will you open yourself to feed back and shaping so that you can tune up your personal knowledge and skills so that you can become much more resourceful, more resourceful than you have ever been before?

___ Will your monitor yourself so that if something comes up as you process the patterns and experiences, you will let us know and your team leaders so that we can support you and enable you to apply these powerful principles to those old memories or meanings.

___ Will your embrace ambiguity, confusion, and even disorientation as you move through the training? In NLP we say that "confusion is the gateway to new learnings." So if you get confused or overwhelmed, just welcome it in and let it be. As you trust the process, you will find new resources and empowerment.

___ Will you agree to *not* introduce patterns and ideas from other disciplines and fields in this training? This is about NLP and while each person brings rich resources from other fields, for the training, we know that it's best to keep or attention on NLP and not everything that you can bring. This doesn't discount the other learnings you have; it just keeps us focused on what we are doing here.

___ Will you agree to be appropriately professional while you are here in terms of your ethics and morality? While we will be making a list of participants available to you, this is not the time to sell your products and services or to get new business.

___ Will you follow the direction and guidance of your trainer(s) and participate as a good team member so that your learnings and skills as well as others can be enriched as much as possible?

NLP— NEURO-LINGUISTIC PROGRAMMING

NLP is first and foremost a Communication Model.

It is a model of how we operate and function given our mind-body-emotion system.
It is a model of how we map or model "information."
It is a model of the structure of resourcefulness so we "run our own brain" and manage our own states.
It is a model of the structure of excellence so we can replicate genius.

NLP began, not with the sensory systems or sub-modalities, but with the *language patterns that two therapeutic wizards used to perform their magic.* Bandler and Grinder happened upon the marvelous languaging patterning of Fritz Perls (Gestalt Therapy) and Virginia Satir (Family Systems) and began studying *how* the words and language patterns performed their *"magic."* They put the results of their study in the books, *The Structure of Magic*, Vol. I and II (1975, 1976).

As also a *description* of human functioning, it focuses on experience, experiencing, and experimenting rather than theory. Via the tools, models, techniques, and patterns, NLP gives us a way to talk about our subjective experiences. By focusing on *description* rather than prescription, we focus on how the processes and mechanisms *work*, how to replicate such (modeling), and how to intervene, transform, and improve human functioning.

NEURO- The voluntary and autonomic nervous system through which our experiences are processed by means of our five senses: Visual, Auditory, Kinesthetic, Olfactory and Gustatory. **Neurology,** the nervous system, the physical foundations for the "abstracting" of the nervous system that begins our "mapping" of the world out there. In our neurological mapping, we map the world using the non-linguistic maps of the sensory systems:

Visual	— Sights
Auditory	— Sounds
Kinesthetic	— Feelings
Olfactory	— Smell
Gustatory	— Taste

LINGUISTIC The *symbolic* mapping that we create of the territory. It involves the higher cortical functions in the brain which enable us to use symbols to create language, and to map things out linguistically. This enables us to encode, order and give meaning to our sensory representations using much more abstract categories.

Language — Words, sentences, syntax, grammar, etc.
Mathematics
Music
Non-propositional language: poetry, stories, narrative, etc.

PROGRAMMING The actual processes or patterns that we use to order and sequence our mapping. Such "programming" generates our *strategies* for functioning, and results in our skills, abilities, habits, etc. We develop "programs" for communicating, parenting, working, relating, etc.

NLP AS A MODEL

We use the word model in numerous ways. Often we say that something is a *model* when we only mean that it is a format or pattern. *A full fledged model* is in entirely different thing. It involves at four things: theory, variables, guiding principles, and processes. The following identifies these four facets of the NLP Model.

The Necessary and Sufficient Pieces that Comprise a Model

1) A Theory: A theoretical background, foundation, hypothesis, etc. that offers an explanatory model for how the model or system works, the governing ideas and how to test and refine the ideas in order to create new applications. Ideas that can be tested and falsified Answers *Why* Questions Epistemology	The NLP Presuppositions Map/ Territory Distinction Gestalt Psychology & Gestalt Therapy Constructionism Batesons' Cybernetics Korzybski Family Systems
2) Variables and Elements: The pieces and parts that make up the components of the model. Answers the *What* Questions. *What* elements are absolutely necessary and sufficient to make the model work? *What* processes?	VAK Representational Systems Sub-modalities Meta-Levels Language Meta-Programs
3) The Guiding and Operational Principles: The "laws" or principles (presuppositions) that define and articulate the mechanisms that make it work and how to use them in a methodological, systematic, and systemic way. This gives one the ability to keep refining the model. Answers the *How* questions: *How* does the model work? *What* processes, mechanisms govern it?	Adaptation of NLP Presuppositions TOTE Model for Strategies
4) The Technologies or Patterns: The specific tools that provide immediate application for using the Model or System to achieve something. Answers *how to* questions: *How* do you reframe meaning? Etc.	More than 150 NLP Patterns

NLP'S HIDDEN THEORIES

The basic NLP presuppositions expresses some of the central ideas that govern the field of NLP. Not only is NLP built upon these presuppositions, but out of them come the impactful techniques that allow people more choice and flexibility in their responses. Whether these presuppositions are "true" in any ultimate sense is not the issue. We utilize them simply because we've found them useful and enhancing as beliefs which enable us to do things. (See *Users*, Ch. 4, pp. 61-84)

1. There is no failure; there is only feedback.

Whatever response you get from someone is simply feedback from them, from their meta-programs for attending to data, from their perceptual grids for processing information and from their internal world of meaning (their model of the world). In other words, it's their stuff; not yours. You haven't "failed," you've just found out what does not work.

2. We all respond according to our map of reality, not reality itself.

In using our maps for navigating the world, we have no other than choice but to refer to them and use them to move through life. Others respond to us, not for what we are, but for what and how they think about us (from their maps).

3. The map is not the territory.

This classic statement from Alfred Korzybski in *Science and Sanity* (1933) establishes the foundational structure of NLP and the epistemology upon which NLP is founded, Constructionism.

4. The response you get is the meaning of your communication.

We never know what we communicate to another person since we never know what they hear or sense or perceive so that it is in the exploring of their response that you can get an idea of what must have gotten communicated. Communication involves a lot more than talking, it also involves sensory acuity and awareness (attentive listening). Successful communicators accept and then utilize all responses offered them.

5. In any connected system, the element with the widest range of variability will always be the dominate influence.

This "law of requisite variety" from the field of cybernetics identifies the value and power of flexibility as a success mechanism.

6. People are not broken; they work perfectly well.

Or, every experience or behavior represents an achievement. The personality mechanisms in people that consistently and systematically operate to do things. Often the problem is the content of what we're putting through these processes; not the process itself. All behavior is therefore geared toward adaptation and is purposeful.

7. People have the resources they need to respond to the world. They only need to access, strengthen, and sequence those resources into effective strategies.

Since people aren't broken, the difficulty must be that they have difficulty accessing their resources to more effectively deal with the things they must deal with. What people may not have are the methods for finding, eliciting, accessing, anchoring, and firing off their resources.

8. We can model excellence by breaking tasks and skills into small chunks to express and replicate the Strategy of the performance.

We can replicate genius only after we have specified the strategy.

9. Mind-body are part of the same system and influence each other.

We hyphenate "neuro-linguistics" to map the mind-body connection and that they work circularly, each influencing the other.

10. It is better to have choice, than the lack of choice.

In changing things, having a sene of choice is one of the most power things we can add to our lives and the lives of others. Adding choices reflects a meta-choice.

11. Neuro-linguistic states are created by, and composed of, internal representations and physiology.

Any and every person's state of consciousness, at any given moment in time, is a result of the thousands and millions of stimuli that the brain (and thus nervous system) receives from the representations we entertain in our minds in terms of visual, auditory, kinesthetic, olfactory and gustatory stimuli. It also results from the millions of stimuli received from our physiology— the way we hold our body, move, breathe, etc.

12. When calibrating someone's reality, the highest information will be behavior.

This includes a person's eye accessing cues, breathing, etc.

13. The fact that we use the same neurological circuits when we remember or imagine, we can use these to create new programs, skills, ways of thinking, and behaviors.

The use of the "As if . . . " frame (imagination) and the "Remember when . . . " frame gives us the ability to learn from the past and build anticipations for the future.

14. Separate Person from Behavior. People are more than their actions, words, emotions, roles, etc.

"Behavior" includes the larger macro-activities and the micro-behaviors of thinking and emoting.

15. Every behavior/ experience has a positive intent.

Similarly, people get organized (structured) inside to accomplish things. Sometimes these purposes cease to be useful, outlive their usefulness, or can be accomplished in more elegant and effective ways. Yet behind every behavior is some positive intent. Finding it allows you to gracefully help a person reorganize themselves.

16. Resistance first and foremost indicates the lack of rapport.

People have a positive intention when they resist what we offer—it saves them by resisting what we seem to be imposing upon them.

17. Every subjective experience has two parts; content and process or structure.

These two parts of experience indicate two different logic levels. It also means that we can effect change at either level. Of the two, process or structure is more pervasive since it indicates a mechanism of the personality.

18. When you don't get the response you want; try something different.

Being "stuck" means that what you are doing is not working so you trying to do it more, harder, louder and with more pressure! The program of "Try something Else!" when what you're doing is not working makes for personal flexibility.

Exercise: Developing a Robust Attitude

1) Identify a desired NLP presupposition:

What presuppositions would you like to commission to become central to your basic attitude in life?

2) Linguistically state it repeatedly . . .

Keep doing so as you refine it until you find a way to express it that feels succinct, memorable, compelling. Exquisitely stated so that the thought puts you into state. Use the presupposition as a spell.

3) Find the corresponding neurology.

Gesture, move, translate the idea into a belief . . . and a state.
Take the concept and give it a symbolic representation in your body by the way you move and gesture.

YOUR PERSONAL OUTCOMES

What are your key personal outcomes for this training?
What do you absolutely want to accomplish by the end of this training?

State your objectives in specific enough terms so that you can check off those that you reach at the end of the training.

1. _____
_____
_____

2. _____
_____
_____

3. _____
_____
_____

Rate Your Skill Level in the Basic Coaching Skills

If you are taking NLP as a prerequisite for the Meta-Coaching Track, where do you think you are today? Rate your competency level on these skills from 0 to 10 given what you currently understand about these skills and how much more potential for growth and development you sense in yourself.

___ *Calibrating:* noticing changes in a person (Listening)
___ *Pacing:* matching a person's behavior, breathing, posture, gestures, tones, and words.
___ *Supporting:* being completely present to another person, creating a context for rapport.
___ *Rapport:* Creating a connection and familiarity with another, inducing comfort (supporting)
___ *Questioning:* asking precise questions for specific responses.
___ *Eliciting States:* influencing a person's moods and emotions.
___ *Anchoring:* Triggering a specific response (State Induction)
___ *Detecting Patterns:* recognizing meta-structures of a person's mental processing.

THE META-COACH TRAINING SYSTEM

An Overview

Models
In Meta-Coaching, there are **7 meta-models** that comprise the overall framework for the art of communicating and coaching. These models are *meta*, that is, *higher* models which are about the content of the conversation. In that, they provide the structure for the coach's expertise in understanding and working with the *dynamic structure or process* of coaching to unleash another person's potentials.

1) *The NLP Communication model*	The foundation for the first 7 core coaching skills, a cutting-edge model about the essential dynamics of communication.
2) *The Meta-States model*	A model about the reflexivity of the mind, how to track our self-reflexive awareness that creates meaning at multiple layers, that enables us to step-back, and the meta-questioning skill.
3) *The Axes of Change model*	A change model based on Meta-Programs that models how self-actualizing people change, how generative change rather than therapeutic change occurs, that gives the coach 9 roles as a change agent
4) *The Benchmarking model*	A model for operationalizing terms, for getting behavioral indicators and equivalents of a "soft" skill and sequencing them along a 0 to 5 continuum to indicate no competence, competence, and mastery.
5) *The Matrix Model*	A systemic model based on developmental and cognitive psychology that provides a template for working with the complexity of the human mind-body-emotion system.
6) *Self-Actualization models*	Several models for how the process of self-actualizing occurs, the Self-Actualization Quadrants, the Matrix of Self-Actualization, and the Neuro-Semantics of Self-Actualization.
7) *The Matrix Business Plan*	A model for developing a holistic business plan or professional development plan that enables one to create specific action steps and plans for developing a viable commercial coaching business.

Days of Training

To provide high quality training for the skills of professional communicating and coaching, the Meta-Coaching Pathway involves the following modules.

Coaching Essentials

The first 3 days introduces the first meta-model—the *NLP Communication model* where you will learn calibration skills, sensory awareness, representational tracking, language precision, and how to "read" people's unique inner worlds.

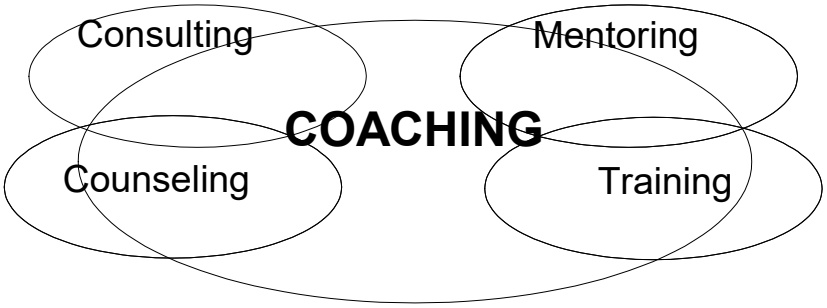
Coaching Genius

Days 4, 5 and 6 introduces you to the *reflexivity model* of Meta-States to empower you in working with the higher levels of the mind and especially to set resourceful frames as a change agent.

Coaching Mastery

Days 7 through 14 (the 8 days of the *Coaching Mastery* or the ACMC training) introduces the *Axes of Change* model, the *Benchmarking* model, the *Self-Actualizing* model, and the *Matrix* model.

WHAT IS COACHING — WHAT IS IT NOT?



What is Coaching?
While coaching is conversation, coaching is not a warm and fuzzy talk feast. Nor is it teaching, training, or telling,. It is not even playing an expert in some domain-specific content. Coaching is about facilitating through questioning, giving feedback, and operating as an expert in process or structure about how we run our own brains for more effective performances. Coaching is *distinct from* the following professional fields. It is *not* consulting, mentoring, counseling or therapy, training, or hypnosis. If it is *not* these things, what is it?

1) Training

Training is a skill-based process for teaching, educating, and leading a person through a process where he or she is enabled to perform the new skills.

2) Mentoring

Mentoring is a process of focusing on a particular skill that a particular individual has. It involves giving advice, guidance, and sharing one's own personal story. In mentoring there is an unequal relationship, senior mentor passing on specific information to a younger and less experienced person.

3) Counseling/ Therapy

Therapy focuses on problems, their sources, the symptoms that result from those problems, how people are broken and dysfunctional, diagnosis of such disorders, and so focuses on healing hurts and bringing resolution to personal pain. It implies that there's something wrong with the person.

4) Consulting

Consulting involves giving advice and using one's own expertise in a given field to inform (tell) the client what to do. While consulting can be facilitative, it can also involve procedures, and helping a client do something new.

5) Hypnosis

Communicating in ways that use words, gestures, and tones hypnotically enable us to induce a person into a hypnotic state for accessing more or new resources. Hypno-therapy for health, psychology, and self-development involves the skill of speaking and communicating to induce a trance.

***

THE NLP COMMUNICATION MODEL

Meta-Program based NLP Practitioner: When you and I communicate, we communicate within our *thinking patterns.* That is, *how* we think governs how we communicate. In NLP we call these thinking patterns *meta-programs* and the Meta-Programs Model governs how we *pay attention* to things, what we sort for, and what governs our perceptual lens.

The Neuro-Semantic way of presenting NLP Practitioner (Meta-NLP) is by beginning with the implied meta-programs that govern the various facets of the Practitioner course.

Meta-Program	NLP Distinction	Communication / Pattern
Day 1:		
VAK Global-Specific	Representational Systems Eye Access Cues	The "languages" of the mind Sensory Predicates Exerecise
Match/ Mis-match Verbal / Non-verbal; Digital / Analogue.	Calibration Skills Matching and Pacing	Like / Dislike Calibration Exercise
Inside/ Outside Options/ Procedures	State and State Induction Choices of resources	Circle of Excellence Pattern State Elicitation Exercise
Day 2:		
Foreground / Background	Moving images from the front to the back, visa versa	The Swish Pattern
Adaptation: Judger / Perceiver Reflective, Active, Proactive, Inactive Uni-directional / Multi-directional		The Movie Rewind
Sensory/ Intuitor: Optimistic / Pessimistic Why / How Quantitative / Qualitative Modus Operandi: Necessity, Desire, Possibility, Impossibility, Choice		The Meta-Model Meta-Model Exercises De-Nominalizing Exercise
Goal Striving: Skepticism, optimizing, perfectionism. Toward / Away From		Well-Formed Outcome

Day 4

Black-White / Continuum.	Meta-States
Static / Process; Aristotelian / Non-Aristotelian	
Causeless, Linear, Complex,	
Personal, External, Magical, Correlation	
Focused / Diffused / Inbetween	
Interactive: Competitive / Cooperative	

Day 5

Reference: Internal / External	Reframing Criticism
Attention: Self / Other	
Preference: People, Place, things, Activity, Information.	Strategies
Introvert / Extrovert / Ambivert	
Convincer: No. of times; Length of time	
Social Convincer: Trusting / Distrusting	
Deciding: Cautious / Bold	
Risk Taking: Aversive / Embracer	
Directness: Inferential / Direct; High / Low Context	
Management: Control, Delegate, Collaborative, Flexibility	
Responsibility: Under- / Over- / To–for Balanced	

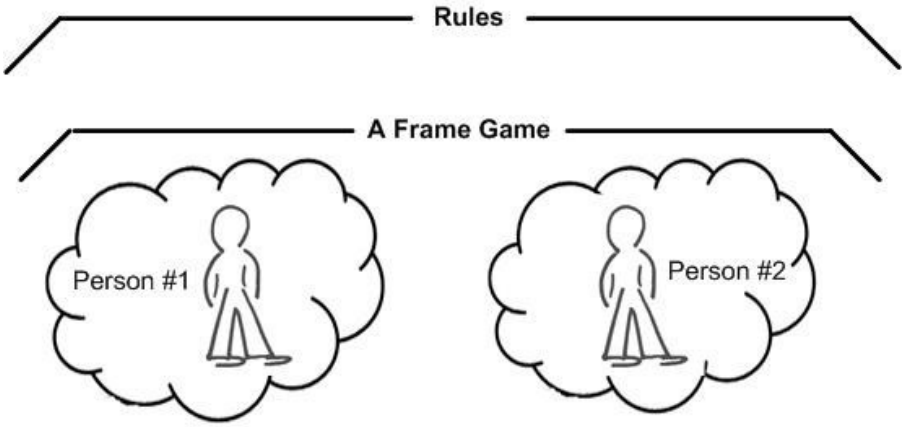
Day 7

Time Zones: Past, Present, Future	Time Lines
Time Experience: In-Time / Through-Time; Random / Sequential.	

NLP COMMUNICATION

Literally communication is the *union* of two people (co-) that results when messages sent and messages received are shared. The *communion* of two or more people sharing an experience or awareness through the exchange of verbal and non-verbal signals. The state of *connecting* and *relating* with understanding.

Communicating is more than talking. We can talk and not communicate. It is also more than understanding another. We can understand and not communicate. In communicating we send and receive messages from another. We take the symbolic signals of another and process them within our mind to "make sense" of them. We then respond in a way that seeks further clarification so that we come to understand another as we represent in our mind a close approximation of what the other has in his or her mind.



The NLP Communication Model is about human communicating and functioning. It is about how we use the languages of the mind (our mental movies and their visual, auditory, and kinesthetic features) to create our mind-body-emotional states. *As a communication model,* this relates to how we process information and involves numerous things:

- It's a model for *running our own brain.* Self-communication awareness comes first. When you communicate to yourself you "run your own brain" in a given way thereby creating your skills, abilities, behaviors, etc.
- We communicate using the languages of the mind— the *languages* that we use to create our cinemas that we play out on the theater of our mind.
- The languages of the mind: Internal sights (visual), sounds (auditory) and sensations (kinesthetics), smells (olfactory) and tastes (gustatory). We "make sense" of things with our senses by internally processing information and representing such as movies in our mind.
- The linguistics of our mind begin with the sensory "languages" of the mind and then moves to the meta-representation system that we call language.
- These languages influence our neurology (our nervous system and physiology) to

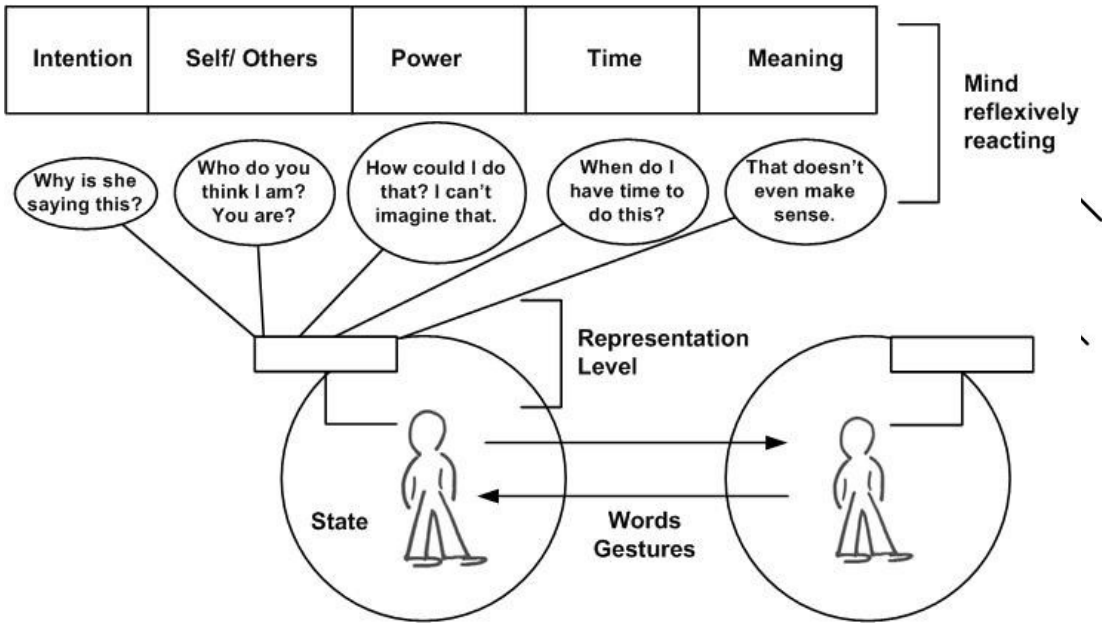
create our states from which come our everyday expressions of behaviors and emotions.

The NLP Communication model facilitates state management (Emotional Intelligence).

- Processing of information induces mind-body-emotion states —neuro-linguistic states.
- States are critically important for communication and everyday life because we communicate from state to state.
- *The quality of your life is the quality of your states.*
- In assessing and inducing states, there are *two royal roads:* mind and body or thinking and acting. You can remember a state, create a state, and model a state.

The NLP Communication model enables us to structure and pattern our experiences.

- This model was developed by a linguist and student of the computer sciences. They used the tools of Transformational Grammar and Computer science to create a model of how human excellence or genius operates in a step-by-step process.
- As we communicate our *know-how* knowledge, we map out skills and strategies for



excellence.

- This communication model is a *description* of human *functioning* rather than a theory. Its tools, models, techniques, and patterns gives us *a way to talk about* our subjective experiences. By focusing on *description* rather than prescription, we focus on how the processes and mechanisms *work*, how to replicate such (modeling), and how to intervene, transform, and improve human functioning.

The NLP Communication model enables us to more effectively cope with the challenges of communicating effectively and professionally.

There are several *challenges* that we all face with respect to communicating

effectively and professionally. Key to them is being able to *transfer* the thoughts in our mind to the mind of another. How do we do that? The *shocking* thing about effective communication is that the least effective way is *telling* or *stating.*

For example, if I want you to believe in me. How effective would it be for me to say, "Believe in me!" Does that transfer belief in me to your mind? Probably not. And why not? There are several problems with it.

1) First, *the problem of representation.* How do I represent in my mind, "I believe in you."? What pictures, words, sounds, and sensations encode that?

2) Second, *the problem of reflexivity*. Because what happens when we hear the words, "Believe in me!"? Do we not jump a level and start wondering, "Why is he saying that?" "What is he try to pull?" Then the "thoughts in the back of our mind," in our matrix of frames are activated.

3) Third, *the differential speed between speaking and talking.* Most people talk between 100 and 150 words a minute, but how fast can *thought* go? I can read at 3,500 words a minute. There are some who can read at 10,000 words a minute. That means the mind can go hundreds, even thousand of times faster than the tongue! That gives a lot of time for us to be *thinking about* a conversation even while we are in the midst of it.

THE META-PROGRAMS MODEL

Design:

To begin to learn the *Meta-Program Model*, to detect the thinking patterns or perceptual filters that govern thinking, emotions, skills, and one's sense of reality.

Outcomes:

- To learn the template of meta-programs that create our perceptual filters.
- To develop some basic skill in recognition and use of the meta-programs.
- To develop an appreciation of their value and importance and how to use them in communicating more effectively and pursuasionally.

Defining Meta-Programs

What are meta-programs and where do they come from?

- We not only *process* information in our minds by *representing* things as a movie in our mind and framing that movie layer upon layer, but we create filters—perceptual filters —that then influence what and how we see. We call these perceptual filters *meta-programs.*

- *We create meta-programs by meta-stating them into existence.* We generalize the state to our basic style of thinking or perceiving. Habituation is what gives rise to the solidification of these ways of thinking so that they become our structured ways of perceiving things. At this stage they govern our everyday thinking-and-feeling as *perceptual filters.*

  Examples: A gestalt thinker who sorts for the big picture will frame most other states with global thoughts-and-feelings.

  Someone who sorts for "necessity" applies a state of compulsion to every other thought-and-feeling state.

- Originating as meta-level thoughts or feelings, we first create fluid meta-states, then as they coalesced, they get into "our eyes" and muscles to become our meta-programs. Meta-Programs arise from meta-states that have been repeated and habituated to such an extent that they have coalesced to create what we feel as a primary state giving us our *perceptual lens* for how we see the world. As such, they comprise a key element in the communication process.

- We can think of meta-programs as a range of perceptual choices along a continuum. When we over-value or over-use a meta-program lens, it typically becomes a *driving* perceptual style or meta-program. We then lose flexibility of perception and consciousness and so this creates a leashing of our potentials.

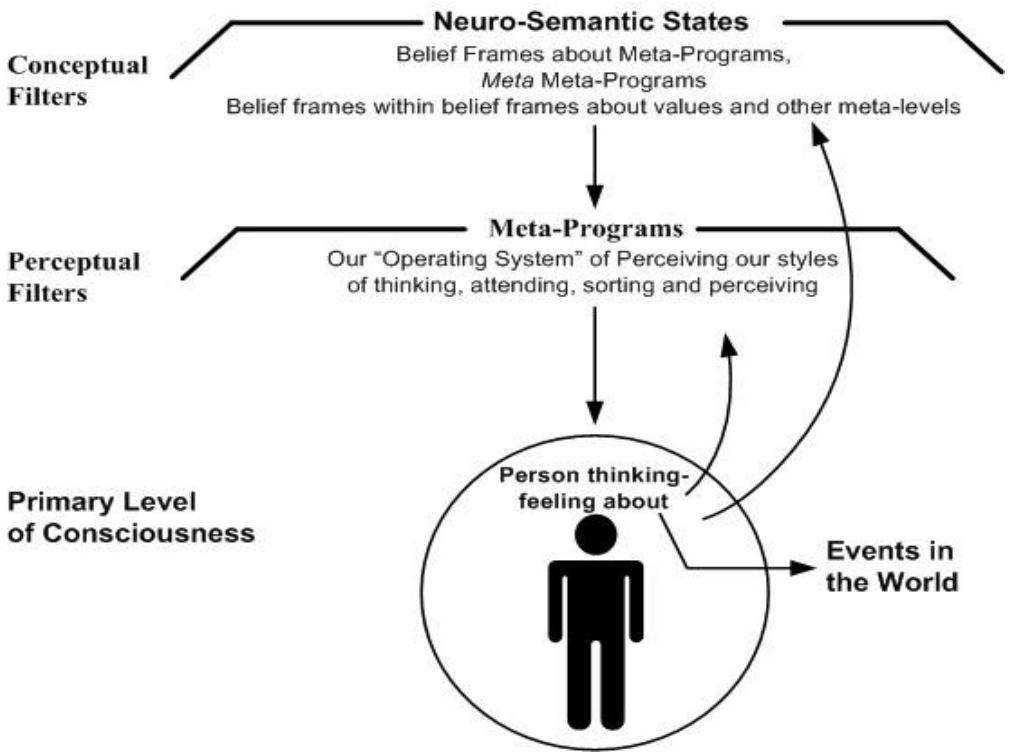
- To the extent that the meta-programs show up in language, we can detect them using the Meta-Model.

  For example, we have favored *modals* that describe our basic *modus operandi* (modal operators) for operating: necessity, impossibility, possibility, desire, etc.

- We *coach to meta-programs* as well as *communicate* to meta-programs because they

offer tremendous leverage points for change, influence, and effective communication. In *Coaching Mastery,* the third module of the Meta-Coaching System, you will learn how to coach to meta-programs as part of the *Self-Actualization process for unleashing new potentials.*

- Learning and using meta-programs is also key to the skill of *detecting patterns* —the one of the prerequisites for the PCMC (Professional Certified Meta-Coach) level.



CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Representation System: VAK. The coding of one's representations.
Scale: Global / Specific. The size of information one is processing. ***

REPRESENTATIONAL CODING AND LISTENING

We "make sense" of things in the world by reproducing or *representing* what we have seen, heard, felt, smelled, and tasted onto the *inner screen of our mind.* As we do that we create some kind of sensory *representation* which we experience as a movie in our mind. This movie may be just a snapshot of a picture, or of a sound, or of a sensation, but it is the beginnings of how we create our mental movies. Each movie has various representations—*visual* (pictures, images, sights), *auditory* (sounds, noise, music, words), *kinesthetic* (sensations, feelings), etc. These *Representation Systems* make up the most basic components of the *languages* of our mind. From these we create the movies in our mind.

VISUAL: Those who prefer and over-specialize in the Visual system—

- Memorize by seeing pictures and are less distracted by noise.
- Often have trouble remembering, and become bored by, long verbal instructions.
- More interested in how something looks, value appearances.
- Will often stand or sit with their hands/ bodies erect and with their eyes upward.
- Breath high, from the top of the lungs.
- Sit forward in a chair, be organized, neat, well-groomed, orderly.
- Often are thin, slender, even wiry.
- Move eyes up to access visual images, look around noticing lots of things.
- Use a higher pitch, talk quickly, in spurts.
- Use gestures that are high, wide, expansive, sometimes will point.

AUDITORY: Those who prefer and over-specialize in the Auditory system—

- Pay attention to sounds, tones, volumes, and find noises more distracting.
- Easily repeat things back what they hear, and learn best by listening.
- Like music and enjoy talking on the phone.
- Highly value tone of voice and the use of specific words.
- Often move their eyes laterally (sideways).
- Breathe from the middle of the chest, talk to themselves, sub-vocalize, memorize sequences, and hold their body to aim their ear.
- Think in more linear, word-by-word ordering, logical.
- Use gestures around the mid-section, adopt a "telephone position," tilt head.

KINESTHETIC: Those who prefer and over-specialize in the kinesthetic system—

- Use their body to think, remember, and communicate.
- May talk slowly and in a breathy way.
- May respond to physical touch and rewards.
- Gesture closer to the body, hand over heart.
- Memorize by doing something or walking around.
- Most interested that something feels right or evokes the right feelings.
- Typically breathe deeply from the bottom of their lungs.
- Move eyes downward to access feelings.
- Tonality will tend to be slower, lower pitch, with hesitations.

LANGUAGE *(Auditory Digital):* Those who prefer and over-specialize in the language systems:

- Want to "make sense" of things by using words.
- Talk in more abstract terms, generalize, theorize, etc.
- May even have little awareness of the sensory based systems.
- Much less use of body, gestures, more in a "computer" mode.

LISTENING FOR THE MOVIES

Not only do we have the three basic representational systems, but within each of these domains, we can make many further distinctions. These are qualities of the sense modalities and make up the cinematic features of our mental movies. If you read classic NLP literature, you will find that these are falsely labelled, "sub-modalities." They are not "sub" or smaller at all, but are actually *editorial frames* and so are our *meta*-modalities. By these we can *edit* the movies of our mind and communicate to ourselves in such a way to change the movie completely.

Visual	***Auditory***	***Kinesthetic***
Brightness	Pitch (low/ high)	Pressure
(from dull to bright)	Location of sounds	What sensations
Focus	Continuous/Interrupted	Location
Color (degree)	Tone	Extent
__ Color/Black-&-white	Number of sources	Moisture
Size	Associated/Dissociated	Shape
Distance	Tempo	Texture
Contrast	Volume (low/high)	Temperature
ovement	Rhythm	Movement (Still/ moving)
Direction	Duration	Duration
Foreground/Background	Distance	Intensity
Location	Clarity	Frequency
Snapshot — movie	Whose voice	Rhythm
(Still — Moving)	Music, noise, voice	
Number of images	Clarity, intelligibility	
Bordered/ Panoramic	Melody	
Shape, form		
Horizontal / Vertical perspective		
Associated/ Dissociated		
3D or Flat (2D)		

Language (or the Auditory Digital) System	**Other Systems**
Location of Words	Smells
Sensory based/ Evaluative	Tastes
Simple/ complex	Balance (Vestibular: dizzy, disoriented, etc.)
Self/ others	
Current/ dated	

LISTENING FOR REPRESENTATIONS IN SPEECH

Representational System Predicates

What are the cues that a person is using any given system of representation to create the movies in their mind? There are linguistic cues for each system. Learning to *listen* for these enables us to detect the way the person is processing information.

Visually:

If I could *show* you an *attractive* and very *clear* way so that you could X (some value), I wonder if you would like to *look* at that and *see* if it does fit with what you're wanting.

Auditorially:

If I could effectively *describe* to you some of the benefits that you really want to obtain, would you like to *hear* about them now or *discuss* them more fully?

Kinesthetically:

If I could help you *get a hold of* this value that you want in a *concrete* way, and in a way that really *embraces* the value fully, would you like to *try it on*, just to *get a feel for it?*

VISUAL

admire	appear	foresee	scan	attractive	form
see	blurred	gaze	shin	bright	glance
show	clear	glare	sight	cloudy	gleam
sight	see	colorful	glow	sparkle	conceal
graphic	dark	hazy	staring	dawn	illuminate
strobe	disappear	imagine	surface	display	obscure
twinkle	envision	observe	vanish	exhibit	look
veil	expose	peer	view	eyed	perspective
visualize	faced	picture	view	flash	preview
vivid	focus	reflect	watch		

Phrases:

seeing eye to eye	appears to me	mental picture	got an eyeful
beyond a shadow of a doubt	mind's eye	bird's eye view	naked eye
catch a glimpse of	paint a picture	clear cut	photographic
pretty as a picture	crystal clear	plainly seen	dim view
a sight for sore eyes	see to it	flashed on	short sighted
get a perspective	showing off	get a scope on	make a scene
horse of a different color	hazy idea	snap shot	image
staring off in space	take a peek	in light of	tunnel vision
In person	under your nose	in view of	

AUDITORY

announce	harmonize	request	answer	harsh	resonance
argue	hear	sang	asked	hum	shout
attune	inquire	shriek	call	insult	shrill
chatter	lecture	sighs	cheer	listen	silences
complain	loud	silent	crescendo	melodious	sound(s)
cry	mention	stammer	deaf	mumble	talk
discuss	noisy	tell	echo	outspoken	translate
explain	overtones	expression	question	utter	growl
quiet	vocal	grumble	recite	yell	gurgling
reply					

be all ears	make music	be heard	manner of speaking
blabber mouth	pay attention to	clear as a bell	power of speech
clearly expressed	purrs like a kitten	call on	outspoken
describe in detail	rap session	ear full	rings a bell
express yourself	state your purpose	give an account of	
tattle-tale	give me your ear	to tell the truth	grant me an audience
tongue-tied	heard voices	tune in / tune out	hidden messages
utterly	hold your tongue	unheard of	idle talk
voice an opinion	inquire into	well formed	key note speaker
word for word	loud and clear		

KINESTHETIC

angle	grapple	skip	beat	grasps	slip
bends	grinds	smooth	bounce	hard	soft
break	hold	solid	brush	hug	spike
burdened	hurt	stuffed	carry	impression	thick
clumsy	irritate	sweep	comfortable	mushy	concrete
movement	touch	crouching	pinch	trample	crumble
plush	tremble	exciting	pressure	twist	feel
pull	budge	firm	rub	unfeeling	fits
run	warm	flop	scramble	wash	force
scrape	weigh	grab	shaky	work	

Phrases:

all washed up	hot-head	be felt	keep your shirt on
boils down to	know-how	catch on	lay the cards on the table
chip off the old block	light headed	come to grips with	control yourself
make contact	connect with	moment of panic	pressure
pain-in-the-neck	cool / calm / collected	pull some strings	hold it, hold on
firm foundations	sharp as a tack	floating on thin air	under handed
slip through	get a hold of	slipped my mind	topsy turvy
get a handle on	smooth operator	get a load of this	heated argument
start from scratch	get in touch with	stiff upper lip	hang in there
get the drift of	throw out	hand in hand	tap into
hands on	turn around		

OLFACTORY/GUSTATORY

bitter	smell	fragrant	smoky	fresh	sour
odor	spicy	pungent	stale	salty	sweet
savor	taste	tang	bite	tongue	aftertaste
essence	inhale	breath	flavor	lick	fume
sip	palate	scent	whiff	reek	a nose for

UNSPECIFIED PREDICATES

conscious	know	learn	aware	light	believe
motivate	change	nice	clear	notice	conceive
perceive	consider	process	decide	question	experience
sense	feel	think	sense	sensitive	understand

LANGUAGE

Meaning	evaluation	significance	compute	count	account
factors	factor in the bottom line				

LISTENING
The Art of Being Present to Another

Listening is attending to a person and paying attention to the key elements in the person's communicating. To listen actively and effectively involves —

1) Sensory awareness to notice and detect the person's state. We call that *calibrating* to the person's experience and mental-emotional state.

2) Representational system understanding to detect, recognize, and record the sensory representational and meta-representational systems that a person uses to make sense of things.

3) Eye accessing cue awareness and acuity to be able to see in experience how a person is processing information and the states that are being accessed.

4) Predicate awareness to detect the kind of language patterns a person is using.

To be an *active* and *attentive* listener, what can we listen for?
We have so many things we can listen for, pay attention to, and be present to.

1) Calibrating to the person's present state and desired state.
2) The physiology of that state in terms of breathing, muscle tension, posture, eye scanning, face, tone of voice, etc.
3) The editorial features of how a person frames the movies in the mind.
4) The representational language and processing of a person.

Yet this is just the beginning. There will be many more things that we can notice if we have the sensory awareness to be present when we are communicating and which occurs in the Meta-Coach System:

5) Meta-Program distinctions about perceptual filters
6) Meta-State distinctions about states and levels
7) Meta-Model distinctions about language
8) Perceptual positions in communicating
9) Where a person is on the *Axes of Change*
10) Where is person is in the *Matrix* of frames
11) Where a person is in the *Self-Actualization* Quadrants
12) Where a person is in the *Performance Analysis* model

CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Match/ Mis-match: How we attend to what is similar (the same) and to what is different in the information before us. How we compare to something else.

Channel: Verbal / Non-verbal; Digital / Analogue. Focus on whether the information is digital and linguistic (language) or analogue in movements, gestures, etc. ***

SENSORY ACUITY SKILLS

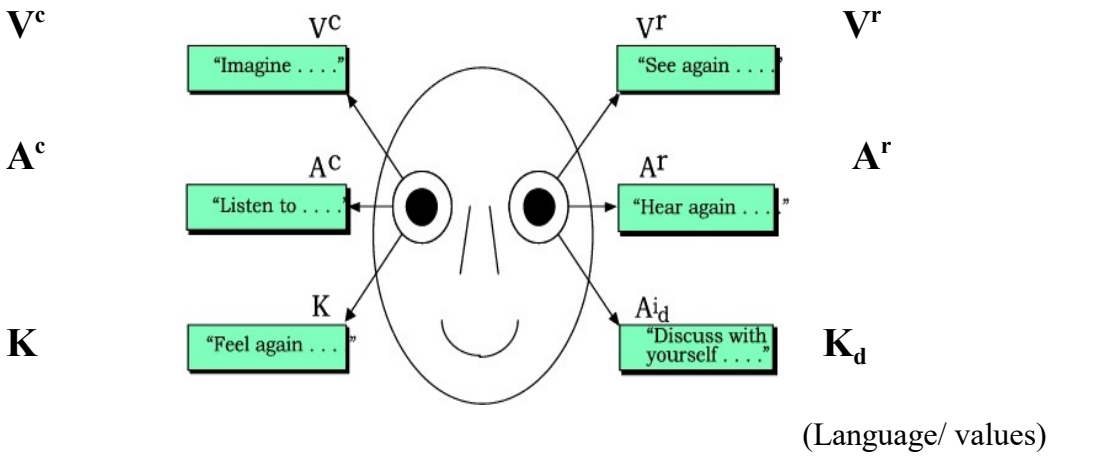
This refers to the art and skill of *calibrating* to a person while accessing a state or experiencing something. In calibrating we pay attention to numerous aspects of the person's behaviors and non-verbal *output.* The following is *not* "body language," rather it is the body's expression of any given person's meanings. None of these responses in the body means anything apart from the person and that person's system.

- **Eyes:**
  - **Focus:** Focused ———— Defocused
  - **Pupil Dilation:** Dilated ———— Undilated
- **Breathing:**
  - **Rate:** Fast ———— Slow
  - **Location:** High ———— Low
- **Skin Color:** Light ———— Dark
- **Skin Tonus or Muscle Tone:** Shiny ———— Not shiny
- **Face: Lower Lip Size:** Lines ———— No lines
- **Voice**: Tone
  Volume
  Quality
  Pitch
  etc.

EYES ACCESSING CUES

We move our eyes in patterned ways that give some indication about what a person is doing inside as he or she is processing information. If we face a person and watch the way his or her eyes move, then the following diagram gives us a way to make sense of what's happening.

Constructed side *Remembered side*



QUESTIONS THAT ELICIT MENTAL MOVIES

Use the following questions to detect and map as you observe another person closely. Notice what happens on the outside in terms of the eye scanning patterns when you ask these questions. You will need to stay in sensory awareness or you will miss it. Then switch partners and experience the inner movies for yourself.

V^r: *Visual Remembered*. Recalling an image or picture.

What was your favorite color as a child? See it now.
What color was your bedroom walls in your childhood home of 12?
What did you wear yesterday?

V^c: *Visual Constructed.* Making up pictures you have never seen.

What is it like when you imagine your car as green with yellow dots on it?
What if you had bright flaming red hair? What would you look like?
What if a traffic light had the green light at the top and the red light at the bottom?

A^r: *Auditory Remembered.* Remembering sounds or voices previously heard.

What does your favorite song sound like?
Are you able to listen again, in your head, to the very last statement I made?
What is the sound of ocean waves lapping on the shore?

A^c: *Auditory Constructed.* Creating and inventing new sounds.

What was the seventh word in "T'was the Night Before Christmas?"

What if I sounded like Donald Duck's tone of voice?
What does the sound of a large rock hitting water sound like?

K: *Kinesthetic.* Feelings, sensations, emotions.
What does it feel to rub your hand over a very fine fur coat?
What is the feel of the warm sun shining on your skin like?
Have you ever dived into a cold stream or an ice pool?

A_d: *Auditory Digital.* Internal talk, dialogue, self-conversation.
What did you say to yourself the last time you made a major decision?
Can you recite the words of your favorite verse to yourself ... now?
What do you say to yourself about what you really want out of life?

CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Inside / Outside: Do you represent your thoughts as if you are fully within and associated into the experience or as if you are on the outside observing?
State Elicitation and Experience: Feeling it as an actor, feeling it as an observer.

CALIBRATION EXERCISES

Basic Calibration

1) Elicit from one person the story of his or her pathway to personal development or coaching for 4 minutes.
2) The Coach observe the client's eye accessing cues, breathing, color, etc.
3) The Meta-Person listen for predicates and watch the entire process.
4) Debrief for 2 minutes.
How much did you stay out of content?
To what extent were you able to identify the structures?

LIKE / DISLIKE PATTERN: Calibrating to Like and Dislike

1) Calibrate for differences.
Pair up and asking your partner to *think of someone he likes.*
Watch for small changes in breathing, posture, muscle tonus, skin color, etc.
2) Next, *think of someone he or she dislikes.*
Watch for changes.
3) Invite the person to go back and forth between thinking of the liked and disliked persons.
Do so until you can clearly see the differences between expressions.
4) *Ask a series of comparative questions*.
This is to test your sensory awareness.
Without telling, the questioner is to just access his or her inner knowing of the answer, not to hide the answer, but just to know it without saying it. Watch the person's response and indicate which one you think it is. Any comparative question will work.
Which one is taller? Has nicer clothes?

Which one have you seen most recently?	Met first?
Which one has darker hair?	More athletic?
Which one is heavier?	Brightest teeth?
Which one lives nearer to you?	Wears ear rings?
Which one makes more money?	Reads more?

5) Calibrating.

When your partner goes inside to process the question and get an answer he may first consider the person he likes then the one he does and finally think of the person who is the answer. You may initially see some back and forth responses. The person's answer will typically be the response you see just before he or she comes back and looks at you, or nods head to indicate that he or she has determined the answer.

When you've guessed correctly four times in a row, switch roles.

Calibrating States

1) Groups of three.

Pair up with 2 other participants.

2) Story telling time.

For five minutes recall four learning experiences and tell it to the others.

Tell about three experiences that are true and positive. Tell a fourth story that is not true, but one you would like to be true. The false story can come in any sequence with your presenting your four stories.

Calibrate to the person's style of communicating.

3) Guess.

After the telling, each person guesses which one is the false one.

4) Debrief.

Using your sensory acuity skills, which one do you believe to be the false one?

Give sensory based descriptions as to why you believe the story contains false information.

Let the storyteller identify the false one.

SUPPORTING
FROM LISTENING TO SUPPORTING

The second core coaching skill is *Supporting.* This refers to relating in such a way that you create a relational and physical *context* for communicating and dialoguing that provides a sense of safety, validity, care, and respect. How do you create a sense and a feel of *safety* for a client, a sense that you are there in a supportive role? There are numerous things you can do:

1) Begin by paying lots of attention and actively listening (Skill #1).
   Reflect back precisely what you have listened to using the person's own words, metaphors, even tone and gestures. Do not paraphrase. That's using your words.

2) Match what and how the person has communicated.
   This is "pacing"—the key skill for getting "instant rapport" with a person.

3) Access a state of empathy, concern, and care for the person.
   This allows you to be a real person in relationship to another real person. Apparently, the danger and temptation of NLP around the world has been that people become so enamored with the "techniques" and "technology" that they forget the person. This has had the effect of de-personalizing and de-humanizing the experience.

4) Focus on fully entering the client's world and space for the purpose of understanding.
   "Seeking first to understand" was one of the seven habits of highly effective people (Stephen Covey). This is an attitude more than a technique.

Design: What's the design in all of this? One thing: to facilitate a sense of safety so another human being feels supported in opening up, disclosing, and experiencing his or her own authentic experience.

Pacing: To create this kind and quality of support, the skill of pacing offers us a truly magical way to enter into another's world with support. *Pacing* is all about matching the client, that is, entering into the person's world to be there with him or her. In this we can pace many things and at many different levels.

1) Physiological pacing: matching the physiological outputs of the client so the person feels that we are together, like each other, and dancing in harmony in energy levels, movements, and voice qualities.

2) Verbal pacing: saying words that fit and match the person's internal world.

3) Meta or conceptual pacing: identifying and mirroring back to the person concepts, ideas, beliefs, values, meta-programs, meta-states, etc. that reflect his or her internal world. Meta-level pacing is a higher level of pacing. Such rapport leads to a person feeling understood.

As you become more professional in your listening, communicating and supporting, you discover more about how to come into sensory awareness, notice what's going on, and then mirror back the speaker's the verbal and non-verbal responses. This reflection acknowledges

the speaker's world as it reflects it back. The result is that it stimulates a feeling of similarity, familiarity, and commonality. The person feels supported, understood, acknowledged. All of this will require a lot of *flexibility* in the communicator.

SUPPORTING THROUGH PACING

What is physiological pacing?

Pacing is *matching* your behaviors and voice to the responses of our client. In the on-going process of matching or pacing, you literally take on the movements, neurology, words, understandings, etc. of the other person (their behavioral *outputs*) and *match* them with your own. Because people are typically not aware of these facets of ongoing experience, they lie outside conscious awareness, pacing communicates unconsciously. It says, "I know your world, I can sense and feel and think in terms of your world of experience."

Matching is the process of adjusting aspects of *your external behavior* to approximate those in the other person's behavior. For example, when a person tilts his or her head to the left, you do the same to match that movement. But do *not* mimick!

How does physiological pacing create rapport?

By pacing or matching another's words and non-verbal expressions (i.e., breathing, standing, gestures, etc.) you create the magic of rapport. That's primary level pacing. You build rapport then by *matching* aspects of another's experiences.

What behavioral outputs can we match?

The following are the key variables in behavior to pace. Mastering this art of pacing will develop our ability to establish rapport with people quickly and proficiently.

- *Matching heads and shoulder angle*: matching the characteristic poses that another offers with his or her head.
- *Matching facial expressions:* seeing the ways that another uses his face (wrinkles nose, puckers lips, raises eyebrows) and match it without mimicking.
- *Matching gestures*: moving in a way that takes on the hand and body gestures of another and to do so gracefully and respectfully. This is not mimicking.
- *Matching breathing*: adjusting your breathing patterns to match the other's.
- *Matching vocal or qualities of speech:* matching another's shifts in tonality, tempo, volume, timbre, intonation patterns, etc.

What degree of physiological matching can we do?

- *Whole body matching*: adjusting our body to appropriate the other person's posture shifts.
- *Part body matching*: pacing any consistent or stylistic use of body movements, e.g. eye blinks.
- *Half body matching*: matching the upper or lower portion of the other person's body.
- *Cross-over mirroring:* using one aspect of your behavior to match a different

aspect in the other person's behavior. If you adjust the tempo of your voice to match the other person's rate of breathing, or pace the other's eye blinks with your finger or head nods.

What does it take to match and pace?

It takes lots of sensory awareness, flexibility in your own responses, and respect for the person. This explains why active listening and sensory acuity is so critical. Pacing is only difficult to the extent that it necessitates lots of uptime experience as you engage another person. It's difficult to the extent that you are not skilled in listening with a third ear to another's depths and entering into his or her world. It's difficult if you do not understand its value or do not care about the person. It's difficult also to the extent that your ego is in the way. Otherwise, it is easy, fun, and profoundly transformative.

What is Verbal Pacing?

Verbally pace by making descriptions that accords with that person's world to convey a sense of having *heard* another. This "empathy" means you are putting yourself into the other's position to see and feel the world as he or she does. You can't this directly; so you have to do it indirectly; which takes attending and listening.

Effective communicators develop this ability of *entering into another's reality.* This makes for true understanding because it takes the other at his word and tries to imagine how his words reflect a perception or map of the world. Entering his reality doesn't mean we have to make it ours or even agree with it. We can maintain our own reality while flexibly imagining and appreciating the other's world as a map.

In verbally pacing someone we momentarily join the other's concept of reality. By going to her model of the world, we can then find bridges to cross over and connect with her. To adopt this strategy, first, recognize the person's reality model.

- What does this word, phrase, metaphor, style of expression imply about this person's model?
- What is this person's orientation to reality?
- What must it be like on this person's insides?
- What could be the source of this understanding or emotion?
- What meanings are at work within this person?

All of these questions invite you to take the other's perceptual position ("second position"). As *map listening,* pacing enables you to get to the other person's reality language so that you can more effectively communicate with each other. Matching your words to the other's internal state, and making statements that are in agreement with, and congruent with, the person's internal, ongoing experience so that the other person begins to feel deeply heard.

You can even purposefully *break pace* in order to engage the other person. Do this by over-stating or over-guessing about the other's reality and asking for feedback and correction. Because we all want to be understood, this will evoke us to help the other person to understand us. By over-stating or under-stating your guesses, you create an opportunity to receive more information and to listening more attentively.

When you verbally pace, your words and non-verbals to serve as *a feedback mechanism* to the other person. This skill is so powerful that when done with appreciation and respect will amplify his experience, engage it, and elicit it even more. This is a *hypnotic process*.

While pacing is simple to understand, at times it can be very difficult to achieve. It demands that you get out of yourself and enter the other's world. It necessitates running your own brain so you don't rush into problem-solving, advice-giving, "that-reminds-me," and judgments.

- *Matching verbal predicates*: hearing the sensory system predicates that predominate in a person's unconscious processing of information, and utilizing it as you match it in your verbal responses.
- *Matching repetitive phrases*: utilizing the person's characteristic phrases and metaphors.
- *Matching the exact words* metaphors, vocabulary, and thought patterns.

What is the difference between matching and mirroring?

To build rapport, match and mirror physiology, and tonality. What differs then between matching and mirroring?

- In *mirroring,* you take on the person's mirror image. If they have crossed their right leg over their left leg, cross your left leg over your right leg. Facing someone, you are opposite them, so mirror them by crossing opposite legs.
- In *matching* physiology with someone who has crossed right leg over left leg, you would match them if you crossed your right leg over your left leg. This works similar to cross-over mirroring.

What is Meta or Conceptual Pacing?

At this level you are pacing a person's beliefs, values, meanings, ideas, concepts, etc. This enables you to gain rapport and enlist support as a basis for communicating. Conceptually pace by temporarily assuming his or her words are correct, then imagine *how* they can be correct.

Pacing reduces repetition in conversation. When we feel heard we don't have to keep repeating ourselves. Pacing can sometimes take some time. After all, it is *connecting with the other person* and so make call up us to exercise patience, calmness, and respect to make contact with the other's reality.

Body Molding as a Mirroring Exercise

1) Form groups of three.

Pair up with someone so that you face another person and a third person is sitting (or standing) behind the second person's line of peripheral vision.

2) Create an expression.

The third person should place him/herself in an unusual posture with unusual facial expressions. Don't overdo it; you will need to hold this position for a few minutes.

3) Replicate that expression.

The first person ‘s job is to direct the second one to take on the same posture and facial expressions as the third person. This will force you to come into sensory awareness and to give good sensory directions.

Action Steps for learning and practicing the art of pacing:

1) Make a decision.

Establish rapport consciously with as many people as you can this coming week. Practice, practice, practice.

2) When eating out.

Match and mirror someone near you in a restaurant. Notice the skills that establish rapport.

3) When shopping.

When you go up to a counter to purchase something, practice establishing instant rapport with the person at the counter.

4) Set up a focused practice schedule.

Train yourself to closely observe different facets of non-verbal communication. On Monday watch for color changes in faces. Tuesday, watch for lower lip size. Wednesday, observe people's breathing patterns. Thursday, notice the variety of body builds and their relationship to the rep systems. Friday, listen for voice tonality and quality. Saturday and Sunday, look for eye accessing patterns.

5) When watching TV.

Use your television time to develop your sensory acuity. Tune into a talk show with your eye accessing chart before you.

PERCEPTUAL FLEXIBILITY

There are multiple positions in perceiving things. When you step into each one of these, you access a different state and a different way of perceiving things.

1st Position – Self The healthy position of seeing, hearing, and feeling from out of oneself. We take this position to speak authentically, to present ourselves, our thoughts, feelings, and responses congruently, to disclose, listen, inquire, be present with another. When you are stuck in this position, you operate exclusively from the self-referent meta-program.

2nd Position – Other The empathy position of understanding, feeling with, and seeing things from another's point of view. Here we feel in accord with the other and develop a strong sense of his or her perceptive. When you are stuck here, you can lose your sense of self and become co-dependent to the person. Doing this means takes on the other-referent meta-program.

3rd Position — Meta The position of stepping back to gain a sense of distance, observe, witness, feel neutral, and appreciate other positions. When stuck here, you come across as uninvolved, over-rational, and in analytical mode.

4th Position — System The position for understanding the contexts (cultural, linguistic, business, family, etc.) that influence all of the larger systems and contexts of our world. When are stuck here, you become "the Company man."

Perceptual Flexibility Exercise

Think about a time when you expressed something in a strong, powerful, and persuasive way and which worked out in a way that really delighted you and the other person. Then think of a time when you were not very resourceful in responding to a criticism or something.

1) Recall a time when you were most resourceful in handling a challenge.

Step back into that memory so that you recall it as if *inside* it again, seeing, hearing and feeling what you saw, heard, and felt then. Answer the following questions from *first position*; use "I" statements.

- What did you experience that was a valuable resource to you?"
- How were you able to access that resource?"

2) Step out of that memory and into the position of the person you were interacting with at the time.

From that person's point of view, look at *the You* in that memory. Physically step aside. From this expanded perspective, express what you see, hear and feel. Use the language of the second perceptual position: "you, he, she."

- How would you describe the person demonstrating that resource?" "He... "She..."
- What did that person do or say that seemed resourceful?"

3) Step aside from this memory and the first two positions to an Invisible Observer to the whole experience.

From the position of an uninvolved Witness, what do you see, hear, or feel *about* that interaction?"

- What do you think about that resourceful interaction from this position?"

4) Step out yet another time to a position out beyond the whole Systems of interactions.

- What additional awareness do you have, understand, feel, etc. as you look at all of that from a larger systems point of view?"

Day 1 Reflections

Reflection on your Day's Learnings, Discoveries, and Competencies:

- What do you now understand about *NLP* that you didn't know before today?
- What's the most important learning of the day for you?
- Did you discover your favorite *representation system* and how it influences you?
- What did you discovered today about "sub-modalities" or cinematic features?
- What did you learn about yourself in terms of operating from global—specific?
- What will you begin to do in the following days to develop your representations?
- How did your watching eye movements go?
- How did you do at hearing predicates in language?
- What did you discover about these languages of the mind that will help your communications?
- What did you discover from the Perceptual Positions pattern?

Marking and Measuring your Learnings and New Skills:

- What is the *one most important learning* that you want to keep with you for the rest of your life?
- Have you made any new empowering decisions about yourself or life? If you did, what would it be?
- How has your appreciation for NLP grown through this day?

DAY 2:

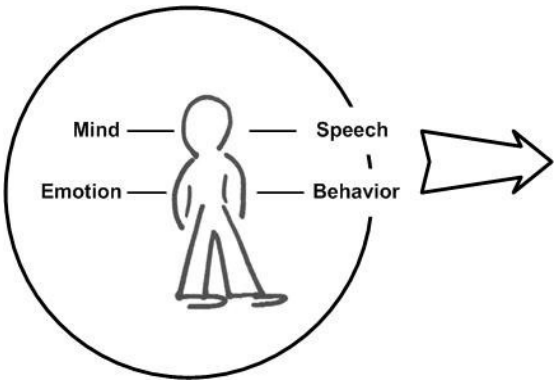
STATES
INDUCING AND EXPERIENCING

Agenda for Day 2:

- Introduce and become acquainted with *states*.
- Discover how we communicate from state to state and what that means.
- Begin exploring the fundamental State Management Skills.
- Learn about State Elicitation and Anchoring Skills.
- Learn and practice the Circle (Sphere) of Excellence Pattern.
- Learn and practice the Swish Pattern.
- Learn and practice the Movie Rewind Pattern.
- Identify the meta-programs that govern all of these patterns and processes.

Orientation Questions for Beginning the Day:

- What do you want to learn and discover today?
- What skills and competencies do you want to develop or refine?
- As you consider the outcomes from this day, set two or three that will be important to you.
- What state do you want to induce yourself into as you begin the adventure today?



CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Inside / Outside of the Representation. You are the *subject* of the experience, the experience as an *object* to you.

Organizational style: Options/ Procedures. Formatting experience in terms of alternatives and possibilities or as steps and stages. ***

In communication, we communicate from a state to a state. This makes states critical and our ability to recognize and manage our states essential.

There are three core skills in coaching competence of *Inducing States*. They involve eliciting, anchoring, and induction.

State Eliciting

The art of identifying, detecting, and providing the required stimulus so that another person elicits a state of mind-and-emotion. To do that effectively, you have to be comfortable with your emotions and those of another. You have to be aware of emotional states and alert to them—able to calibrate. You have to have the flexibility in offering a wide range of triggers to call forth a state.

State Anchoring

The art of being able to establish a trigger or link to a state, to do so consciously and to be able to replicate it at will. Once you can do that, then you can develop the skill of calling forth the state you anchored, "firing it off" by replicating the linkage.

State Induction

The systematic ability to provide an induction by means of a story, an anchor, a menu list, and a wide range of options so you can invite others into more resourceful states.

Definition of State—

- A *state is a mental and emotional state,* a dynamic mind-body state of experience or being that operates as an experiential energy field. We *experience* life in specific mental and emotional *states.*
- Our *state* of mind*, state* of body, *state of emotion* are all so inter-related that the state cannot be separated. When you do, it is only linguistically separated and as a description. *As* you think, *so* you feel in your body and move and act and this entire configuration (or gestalt) is what we mean by "experience."
- We live and move and have our being as *a neuro-linguistic class of life.*
- As a neuro-linguistic class of life we *experience and map* the territory beyond our skin, the world "out there" so that we can effectively relate to it. This means that most fundamentally, we operate as pattern detectors and mappers, and this gives us our most unique ability to *program* ourselves.
- As we map things, so we become. It begins with our ***neurology***, how we use our nervous system and sense receptors. It also involves our ***linguistics,*** how we use symbols, words, metaphors, and classifications to create mental and emotional programs.

- Now discover take charge of these processes and run your own brain.
- Taking charge of your "reality constructions" empowers you in managing your neurology, building ever-more accurate and enhancing models of the world increases your resourcefulness. This is the foundation for effective communication — *excellent state management.*

State Components:

If we *create* our states from our mental-emotional-somatic mapping, this gives us *two royal roads* to state. Two avenues that we can use to evoke or induce a state.

1) Mind —> Linguistics:

Internal representations specify our state of "mind"—the things that we internally map out visually, auditorially, and kinesthetically (VAK) as well as the things that we say to ourselves (language), our "understandings, learnings, beliefs, values," etc. that make up the representations on "the theater of the mind." Because you always have a choice about what to represent and how to code that representation, you have *representational power*.

The languages of the mind, how the mind "thinks" and encodes information. In NS we call the result, the representational screen or internal cinema or movie of the mind (see *MovieMind*, 2003).

The sensory representation systems:

Visual: pictures, scenes, images
Auditory: sounds, noises, music
Kinesthetic: sensations, touches, tactile, proprioceptive, motor movements
Olfactory (smell), Gustatory (taste), & Vestibular (balance)

The language representation system (auditory-digital)

Words, Sentences, Linguistic structures
Mathematics, Music symbols, Metaphors, Stories, Symbols

2) Body —> Neurology:

Physiology and/or Neurology describes the physical state or state of "body"—the things that we experience in our body involving health, posture, breathing, bio-chemistry, etc. The functioning of our nervous system as it interacts within our body and physiology of our central, peripheral, and autonomic nervous systems.

Together, ***mind-body*** *makes up our* ***states*** –the interface between neurology and the "languages" of mind by which we encode the information of the process world "out there" and in the process world "inside." This structure of our mind-body states serves as the basis for *Meta-States,* the higher levels of the mind. Alfred Korzybski first coined the terms, *neuro-linguistics* and *neuro-semantics* and used them interchangeably. Here we use *Neuro-Linguistics* for primary states and *Neuro-Semantics* for meta-states.

STATE MANAGEMENT #101

State Object:

In primary states (i.e., fear, anger, joy, calmness, sadness, etc.) the **object** usually refers to something *outside* you and "beyond" your nervous system.. *What* do your thoughts-and-feelings refer to? What's on your mind?

In meta-states, the object of our state is another state so that we are now in reference to ourselves, to our own experiences of thoughts and emotions. "I feel joy about my learning."

State Awareness:

Awareness of the states and the factors that drive them. Because all states *habituate*, they drop out of conscious awareness. Notice the quality of the state: How "pure" your state? How much congruity? Complexity or simplicity? Meaning or semantics? Pain-pleasure quality?

How is the state *encoded and structured?* Identify the qualities, properties, features, distinctions in the representations governing its intensity (i.e. vivid, sharp, quick, degree of movement, etc.).

A tool for greater state awareness is Bubble Journaling (See *Sourcebook of Magic*).

State Assessing/ Inducing:

1) Memory: *Remembering a state.* "Recall a time when . . ."

2) Imagination: *Creating a state*. "What would it look, sound, and feel like if . . ."

3) Modeling: *Observing a state*. "Do you know anyone who . . ."

State Altering:

States do not stay the same, but forever change. Count on your states altering, shifting, and transforming. What methods do you have for *altering* your states?

State Intensity and Amplification:

Gauge each state in terms of intensity. How much do you experience the state? What level of strength or weakness does the state convey? How much does it dominate your consciousness? Do you need more? Crank it up by increasing or intensifying the inner movie and you will experience more of the state. All states do not have the same level of intensity, so gauge for intensity level. Do you need more "juice?" What processes do you rely on for amplifying your states? How do you crank them up?

State Interrupts:

Stop any and every mind-body-emotion state by jarring, interfering, sabotaging, preventing, etc. *State Interrupts* refer to ways for stopping or preventing a state from functioning.

State Dependency:

States govern our learning, memory, perception, behavior, communication, etc., state-dependent LMPBC. State dependency is called "emotional expectational sets" or "conceptual expectational sets" determining what we see and hear.

State Contrasts:

Compare one state with another to gain insightful understanding about "the difference that makes a difference." What explains the difference? Does it occur at a primary or meta-level?

All states are not the same. State configurations come in all sizes and shapes. Just because you have accessed a state of thoughts-and-emotions and physiology, you may not access a similar state to someone else doing the same.

Anchoring a State:

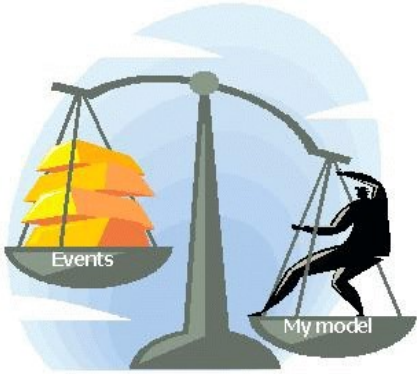
Set up a trigger (sight, sound, sensation, movement, gesture, word, etc.) and link it to the state. *"Anchors"* operate as Pavlovian conditioning tools for state management and depend on uniqueness, intensity, timing, purity. Wait until you or another person has reached the *peak* of the experience, then link some *unique trigger* to it. Test to see if the *trigger* then "fires off" the state. If so, you have an "anchor."

State Utilization:

Detect and then use resourceful ways of thinking-feeling, perceiving, communicating, etc. "Where would I like to use this state?" "What would it look, sound, feel like to have this state in this or that situation?"

State Strategy:

The pieces of information (VAK), neurology, responses, etc. that comprise the sequential composition of a state. Track down this sequence and model the pieces of *the strategy* that creates the state.



State as "Emotion" (K_{meta}):

An emotion is a combination of sensations and languaged evaluations in the form of words *about* the kinesthetics; a meta-level phenomena, "emotions" consist of *evaluative judgments, beliefs, meanings, values.* As "states" (neuro-linguistic states) emotions register our body's (or soma) sense of the meaning or evaluation to help us feel the energy of the meaning.

An emotion is the difference between our *model of the world* (which includes all of our mappings about what we want, expectations, expect, believe, understanding, etc.) and our *experience of the world* (what actually happens at the contact point of our skills and actions). The difference between the two is our *emotion* (diagram by Mike Davis).

The *primary* emotions already operate as a meta-level phenomena, K^{meta}. Technically we could *tease out* yet another *lost level* (or coalesced level) inside the primary state: a set of kinesthetic sensations plus a cognitive evaluative judgment of meaning. Our primary emotions already involve cognitive evaluations from a previous meta-level

having **coalesced** into a primary state. This illustrates how meta-levels merge with primary states.

State Extending / State Containment

We can both *extend* and *contain* states—these properties of neuro-linguistic states enable us to take the thoughts-feelings and all of the mind-body correlations and contaminate other experiences with a state. We can also build boundaries and barriers around a state so as to disconnected to other things. In various contexts, both phenomena provide new resources if used appropriately.

State Expressions versus State Frames

We have 4 central *expressions* of State: Thinking-Feeling, Speaking, Behaving.

T — What do you think about this or that?
F — What do you feel?
S — What do you say?
B — What do you do?

STATE ELICITATION SKILLS

The ability to effectively elicit responses, states, experiences is crucial to be a professional communicator. The skill of elicitation enables us to discover the structure of subjective experiences wherever you find them whether in ourselves or in others. The skill of eliciting enables us to learn how to effectively transform experiences. It's crucial for effective communicating, persuading, motivating, etc. *Eliciting* helps the person you're talking with to become conscious of factors that are normally outside their range of conscious awareness. This means your own patience, positive expectation, and acceptance will make it easier (and safer) for the other person to access the information.

1) First, move to an uptime state.

Get yourself in the right state of being present to the person.
Open all of your sense receptors to input sights, sounds, sensations, etc.

2) Invite a past memory, future imagination, or model.

To elicit clean information about a person's experience you need to get the person into the state. If you don't get the person in state, you will only be talking *about* the experience.

Think about a time when you were thinking or feeling ...
What would it like if you were fully experiencing ...?
Do you know anyone who does experience ...?

3) Aim for referents that are small and simple.

To elicit as a pure and discreet state as possible, ask the person to think about a referent event or experience that is clear, small, and simple. When asking for a "Strong Belief" pick something that isn't so emotionally laden as "I'm a Worthwhile person," but "I believe learning can be fun." "I believe developing my skills."

4) Speak and act congruently.

In eliciting a state, remember that the tools of your trade are *what* you say and *how* you say it (your tones, tempo, gestures). So be evocative. Sound like what you are trying to elicit. Make your expressions sound congruent to what you are eliciting.

5) Take your time to allow people sufficient time to process things.

We all do not process information or emotions at the same rate. When a person "goes inside" grant them the space and room to do that by being quiet. Let them process.

6) ***Begin with unspecified terms and then shift to more predicate specific terms.***

Begin with unspecific words that allows the person to search for the experience in his or her own way. As you notice the accessing of certain representation systems, help the person by then using sensory-specific words. If you hear a visual term then say, "And what do you see...?" Good downtime questions will assist the person in locating and identifying the experience. To do that you will need just enough content so as to ask good questions. In fact, that's the primary value of knowing some content.

7) ***Focus on the form and structure of the eliciting.***

Throughout the person's accessing and experiencing , focus on the form and structure of the experienced by paying attention to the modalities and the cinematic features of those modes.

ANCHORING

In communicating/coaching we are working with mind-body-emotional states. Once a state has ben accessed, we can anchor it so that we can utilize the best states or more effective deal with the less than resourceful state. In the process of anchoring, we help the person recall a discreet experience by asking for specifics of it. In doing this we invite the person to choose one experience and ground it in specifics.

1. Intensity

How intense is the state?
As you gauge it from 0 to 10, where are you?
What increases the intensity of your state?
How quickly do you change states? Calibrate to the speed of someone going into state.

Capture the state at the peak of its intensity and anchor when the person goes into the desired state. If you are touching, increase the firmness of your touch as their state increases and then release just after the peak of the experience.

2. Purity

How pure and discreet is the state? How mixed?
How focused is the person's attention?
Is he or she thinking about one referent or a group of them?

3. Uniqueness

How unique is the new stimulus of the anchor?
When kinesthetically anchoring, where will you touch?
How much pressure, for what length of time?
Do you have a location you can easily return to?
Avoid setting a touch anchor in an area that's regularly touched.
Touch a precise place on the skin, not the clothing which will shift.

4. Timing

In replicating an anchor, you "fire it off" by returning to the precise location with the same stimulus and apply the same pressure for the same amount of time. Apply a firm steady pressure, but never in a painful way, or too faintly. Then hold it. Gradually increase the pressure as the person goes more fully into the experience. It takes time for people to completely re-experience a state. When learning to anchor, have the person signal you when they're in the desired state; it'll help you calibrate.

Anchoring Exercise

1) In pairs, access a state of relaxation.
Use your elicitation skills.

2) Amplify the state until it is strong and robust.
Use your calibration and questioning skills.

3) Set an anchor for the relaxation state.
Use your anchoring skills.

4) Break state and then test the anchor.

STATE ACCESSING AND ANCHORING PATTERN

We communicate from a state to a state. It's inevitable and inescapable. But what state? Is it a useful, productive, and/or resourceful state? Are we communicating to a person in a state that enables him or her to communicate effectively? If not, then we need to elicit or access a more resourceful state.

1) ***Identify*** *the desired state and it's mind-body components*.

What state do you want? Describe it a little bit.

As you're talking about that state, are you beginning to *enter into that state?*

2) Evoke it fully.

Think of a time when you fully experienced this state...

Think of a time when you clearly had it in a powerful way.

What thoughts really evoke this state?

What do you need to do

How much do you now have the feeling of this state? Be with that feeling... let it grow... now let it double...

What would increase the experience of this state even more?

What would it be like if you did fully experience this state? Use this if you're having any difficulty eliciting the state.

Do you know anyone who experiences this state?

3) ***Anchor the state*** *when it is highly amplified.*

Set a physical touch on arm, forearm, or shoulder as the person reaches the peak of the state (a 8 or above on a 0 to 10 scale). Or anchor it visually through a gesture, auditorially by a particular tone.

4) ***Practice stepping in and out.*** *Break state and repeatedly re-access .*

In just a moment I want you to step out of that powerful state, but before you do, take a snapshot of it in all sensory systems (what you see, hear, feel, etc.). Now let's practice stepping in and out of that state so that you can quickly "fly into that state" at any time you choose.

5) ***Apply*** *the resourceful state to a time or place in everyday life.*

Where could you really use this state in your everyday life as you engage in various wealth building activities?

Think of that time and *feel this* (fire the anchor).

Suppose you had this feeling or way of thinking as your attitude, fully and completely, in just the way that you would want it —would you like that? –> **Yes**

Would that attitude transform things as you think about that activity? –> **Yes**

How would it transform things... just notice inside... and enjoy. –> **Yes**

CIRCLE OR SPHERE OF EXCELLENCE PATTERN

- What are you best coaching states? How much access do you have to them?
- How available are they to you? What are your *top ten?*

Integrity	Ruthless compassion	Congruity	Good boundaries
Curiosity, Wonder	Solid sense of self	Caring, compassion, love	
Firm, strong, resourceful, ego-strength		Respect and awe	
Clear, understanding, knowledgeable		Flexibility	
Energetic, alive, vital	Engaged, focus, present	Accepting	Open, vulnerable

1) Identify an excellent state.

What state would you would like to have available for your use, a state which would allow you to act from your full capabilities?

2) Imagine a circle on the floor.

Visually imagine that there's a circle in front of you on the floor and make sure that it is big enough for you to step into.

3) Fill up the circle with symbolic colors of the resourcefulness.

What color would you like to use to symbolize the resource?
Notice how the qualities of the circle grow and develop and become richer for you in terms of their color, texture, material, size, etc.

4) Take a meta-position.

What you ever had a time when you experienced that resource? As you recall that instance, stand outside the circle, and let the circle fill up with those qualities ... qualities that you want to have available now and in the future.
If needed, pretend you have these qualities or model them from someone else who does have them.
What do you see? Hear? Feel? What do you say to yourself?
How are you holding your body when you are experiencing these resources fully?
Anchor this state in all sensory systems.

5) Step into the circle and make it a sphere.

Seeing yourself possessing all of these qualities and resources, now step into the circle and breathe them in fully.
Hear what you say to yourself, see what you look like and notice what you now feel.
Fire all anchors as you amplify the state or states in your circle of excellence.
Experience your thoughts and feelings fully.
As you do, let the circle become a sphere . . . a bubble . . . a space . . . from which you live and move...

6) Future pace.

As you continue to experience the circle, see, hear and feel yourself performing in the days and weeks to come . . . using this state as you move through the world. Notice

when and where you will want to use this.

7) Break state and test.

What did you eat for lunch two days ago? (State interrupt)

Now step back into this circle and fire your anchors for your state of excellence.

CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Information Staging: Foreground / Background. How one sets up the "stage" of information within one's mind, what's in the front, what's in the back. ***

THE SWISH PATTERN

Communicating directionalizes our brains so they go places. We mostly do this haphazardly, but we can do so more mindfully. We can set up a positive picture that we want to move toward and link it to a troubling trigger. In this way we can teach our brain where to go. The Swish pattern is very generative because it creates a new direction. We now move toward a self-image of the kind of person we want to become. Swishing can propel you in that direction.

The Pattern:

1) Identify an experience to be changed.

What response or habit do you want to transform?
Do you have any responses that you would like to re-wire?
Would you like to attach a new response to an old trigger?
Identify the context where the trigger occurs, where the feelings or behavior occurs.
(Menu list: Biting your nails, smoking)
When, where, how, etc. do you do this? Teach me.

2) Identify the experience's inner Movie and its internal representation.

What is the undesired state, describe it as full as possible.
What is the *Cue Picture*, sound or sensation?
When do you typically do this?
Imagine you are doing that, you bring one of your hands up, and start to bite nail, smoke, etc. Go through the motions.
The Cue representation sets off the old response. It's the button that triggers your response.

3) Develop a desired outcome Movie or representation.

If you no longer bit your nails, how would you see yourself as being different?
Would that be valuable to you? How? What will be different? How will you be different?
What difference would it make to you as a person?
What would it mean about you?
What would your desired self-image look, sound and feel like?
Do you like this new picture?
Do you find it compelling? Attractive?
Does it draw you toward it? [Keep editing until it is.]

4) Link the two representations.

Begin with *the Cue Picture* of the trigger, step into the movie and be there.
Put the *Me for whom this is no problem* in the lower right corner or in the middle of that picture.
Have you embedded that desired picture into the cue picture? Good.

5) Prepare to Swish.

In just a moment I want you to quickly allow the Cue Picture to fade out, to dim out, to move far back into the distance *and at the same time* I want you to let the dot that contains the Desired Image to very quickly get bigger and brighter and closer. As the Cue Picture gets smaller and darker and at more distance (use the cinematic features that drive your responses), let the New Picture swish in and completely cover the screen of your mind. Juice it up so that it is there in 3-D and coded in the ways that your brain knows is "Real, Compelling, and Attractive."
You will do all of this very quickly, in less than a second.

6) Swish!

Do it. Quickly fade out the images . . . let them move back into the distance and quickly watch the dot explode into the center of the screen . . . watch it get very big and bright and close.

7) Swish five times.

Have you finished? Good. Now close your eyes and blank out the screen. Or, open your eyes and look around.
Now, let's do it again. Go back to the linked pictures and repeat this process five more times. Clear your mental screen after each Swish.

8) Test.

Good. Now let's test this to see if it works. After all, that's the important thing.
I want you to just allow yourself to think about the triggering Cue Picture that used to set you off and put you into the reactive state. Got it?
Notice what happens.
As you think about that old trigger, does your brain now immediately go to the new picture?
Good. That means you're done. You have successfully swished your brain so that it now has made a link. It now knows where to go.

COLLAPSING ANCHORS

As we work with states, we either *build up neurological energies* or we *disperse those energies.* Building up energies is amplifying states, eliciting sub-modalities that juice them up, bringing in resources, meta-stating, etc. Dispersing energies means tearing a neuro-linguistic (mind-body) program apart, deframing it, meta-modeling it.

1) Access a state.

What state do you want to take the emotional charge out of?
How much are you accessing that state right now?
As I set this as an anchor for that state, nod when you reaccess that state even more, how is that? How much are you experiencing that limiting state?

2) Access a contradictory state.

When would be a powerful resource state for you given the limiting state? [Menu: relaxation for tension, playful for serious, etc.]
When were you most fully and completely in that state? What was that like?
How much are you experiencing it now?
Now that I've set an anchor for that state, how well does it fire it off when I do this [fire the anchor]?

3) Fire both anchors simultaneously.

Now are you ready to collapse these states?
There's no need to do anything, just experience. Just let it happen. So notice what happens when I do this [fire both anchors simultaneously and hold them]. What is that like?
Is there any confusion or disorientation as your neurology tries to process both experiences at the same time?

4) Refresh the resourceful state.

Let's go back to your resourceful state, as you recall it, how much do you have it back?
What do you need to do to amplify this state?

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CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Adaptation: Judger / Perceiver; Controlling / Releasing. Formatting attention in terms of response to the information.

Somatic Response: Reflective, Active, Proactive, Inactive. Formatting attention to how to respond to a stimulus.

Emotional Containment: Uni-directional / Multi-directional. Formatting attention of emotion within a context. ***

MOVIE REWIND PATTERN

"Phobia Cure Pattern:" Because we think by playing movies forward in our mind, what if we rewind a movie? What happens then? Communicating a "reverse" and experiencing *a reverse* from inside a movie has the effect of de-energizing, even erasing, a movie. It has the effect of un-creating the movie. This can become valuable for old movies that we no longer need to play, esp. for those that were hurtful and ugly. *The Movie Rewind pattern* recodes our mind-body-emotion system so that when we simple "think" about something, it will no longer evoke or induce a phobic state, or out-of-control semantic reactions. We can think and feel comfortable. It takes the negative emotional charge out of a memory or thought.

1) Think about the representation or memory as if just witnessing it.

I want you to imagine yourself sitting in a movie theater. Now upon the screen in this mental theater, you see a black-and white picture of the memory, of the younger you in some situation *just before* the fearful, traumatic, or unpleasant event or events occurred. Got that?

Now freeze-frame this scene just prior to the Movie so that it appears as a snap-shot. Is it a black-and-white snapshot? If not, then let the color of the picture fad out.

Now sit back to watch it, aware that you have taken a spectator's position to that younger you. Notice that you have stepped out of the picture and observe it from outside. This changes how you are feeling *about* it, doesn't it? And you can sit comfortably eating your popcorn or whatever you like to snack on.

And as you gain this psychological distance, just be a witness to that old snapshot, delighted that you can step aside even further. Because taking this spectator position to your old memories enables you to *begin to learn* from them in new and useful ways. You might notice that your younger self in the memory thought-and-felt from a less resourceful position than you have now, setting here, and observing with your adult mind. And this can give you a new and different perspective, does it not?

2) Float back to the projection booth to watch yourself watching.

Imagine now floating out of your body as you sit there in the tenth row and just float back to the projection booth that's behind you and above you. From this point-of-view, you can see your observing self in the tenth row watching the black-and-

white snapshot on the screen, can you not?

From this position, you can put your hands on the glass or the plexi-glass to remind yourself that you are not in the picture, not even in the theater, but way back here in the projection booth, the place where you can control things. How much distance do you have between yourself and the movie? How safe and secure do you feel here in the control booth?

Now as you watch this movie, notice the cinematic features. Notice it's size, whether it is clear or fuzzy, the sound track, volume, pitch, tone of voices, etc. Be a good film critique about the cinematic features.

As you begin with the visual system, just notice whether you have the picture—in color or black-and-white? A movie or snapshot? Bright or dim? Close or far? As you make these distinctions, you can begin to choose which coding would enable you to *think comfortably about* that memory so that you can stay resourceful and thoughtful in a relaxed and comfortable way.

Notice the sound track and the auditory qualities. Do you even have a sound track? What sounds do you hear coming from that movie? What quality of tones do you hear? At what volume, pitch, and melody? And what about the words being used? What words do you hear from that younger you? From where do you hear these words coming? Notice their tone, volume, and location. As you notice how that younger you feels, what sensations does that person have in his or her body up that on the screen? Where and at what intensity, weight, pressure?

3) Now let the old memory play out as you watch it from the projection booth.

From the projection booth, let the initial snapshot turn into a black-and-white movie, and just watch it play out to the end from this control booth. Watch it from the beginning to the end . . . Good. And if it needs to speed up to get through it, just fast forward it.

Let the Movie play past the end to a time when the unpleasantness is all gone, when those scenes disappear and play it until you can see that younger you in a time and place of safety and pleasure. And when you find that scene of comfort . . . whether it occurred at that time or whether you have to fast forward your memories to some future event of pleasure, even years into the future, do so. Got it? Good. Stop the Movie and freeze frame the comfort scene.

4) Step into the comfort at the end of the movie and rewind.

Now I want you to step into the comfort scene where there's pleasure and delight and just be there. Step in ... at the end of the Movie and be there, and feel that comfort fully . . . Do you like that? Let it grow and fill all of your body. Isn't that nice?

Now in just a minute we are going to *fast rewind* this memory and do so in super-fast rewind speed. You have seen movies and videos run backwards, haven't you? Well, I want you to rewind this movie at the fastest rewind speed imaginable, in just a moment

or two and to do so while you are ***inside*** this Movie. From your vantage point, you might see a confusion of sights and a jumbling of sounds as everything zooms back to the beginning and as you zoom backwards to that original snapshot.

Ready? Step into the comfort scene at the end of the movie, feel the feelings of comfort, turn on some pleasant music ... Do you feel that comfort scene? Good. Now push the rewind button and experience it rewinding ... zoooooooommmmm. All the way back to the beginning.
There you go. It only takes a second or two to do that fast rewind, and how did that feel . . . rewinding from inside the movie? When you experience the fast rewinding, all the people and their actions go backwards. They walk and talk backwards. You walk and talk in reverse. Everything happens in reverse, like rewinding a movie.

6) Repeat this process five times.
Was that weird or what? Well, let's do it again. Are you ready for this? Clear the screen in your mind. Take a short break and shift your awareness; open your eyes and look around. Now, go to the scene of comfort at the end again, and *as soon as* you step it, feel, see, and hear it fully . . . rewind the movie even faster. As you do this over and over your brain will become more and more proficient and the rewind will go faster and faster until the rewind takes only a second each time. Zoommmm!

7) Test the results. [Break state from this exercise for a few minutes.]
How was that? You know things come apart when you rewind things. How about this? Sense makes nothing then and apart comes syntax th, backwards, a sentence a read we when. When we read a sentence backwards, the syntax comes apart and then nothing makes sense. So with our memories, scrabble them with this rewind method, and it's hard to even call up the original memory and feel bad. See if you can do it? Can you, can you get the unpleasant feelings back? Try really hard and see if you can recall the trauma Movie.

Day 2 Reflections

Reflection on your Day's Learnings, Discoveries, and Competencies:

- What do you now understand about *states* that you didn't know before?
- How much state management do you have now? How much more do you want to experience?
- What did you discover about accessing and eliciting states?
- How will this help you?
- How did your experience with the Sphere of Excellence Pattern go?
- Did you have any breakthroughs with the Swish Pattern?
- How did your experience with the Movie Rewind Pattern go?
- Do you understand how you can take the emotional charge out of any old memory that might haunt you?
- What did you learn about the meta-program thinking-patterns today?

Marking and Measuring your Learnings and New Skills:

- What is the *one most important learning* that you want to keep with you for the rest of your life?
- Have you made any new empowering decisions about yourself or life? If you did, what would it be?
- How has your appreciation for NLP grown through this day?

DAY 3:

THE LINGUISTICS OF NLP

Agenda for Day 3:

- Discover the magic in the structure of language, the Meta-Model
- Discover and learn the Well-Formed Outcome Pattern

- Identify the four categories of meta-programs
- Learn and practice the Expanding Meta-Programs Pattern

Orientation Questions for Beginning the Day:

- What do you want to learn and discover today?
- What skills and competencies do you want to develop or refine?
- As you consider the outcomes from this day, set two or three that will be important to you.
- What state do you want to induce yourself into as you begin the adventure today?

PRECISION QUESTIONING

Questioning on first encounter seems like such an obvious and easy skill. It seems that way, but it is not. Because speaking, telling, giving advice, instructing, etc. *feel* more powerful, almost all of us default to some form of telling. It takes a real master to *ask questions* and use inquiry to facilitate the self-actualization in another. *Question* is the skill and art of asking great questions that invite a listener to go inside and find and/or create the answer—an answer that facilitates the other persons resourcefulness and confidence to answer.

Have you ever been questioned in that way?
Do you know any true masters of the art of inquiry?

1) We communicate best by questioning because as the person finds his or her own answers, those answers will be more memorable and the person will assume more ownership.

2) We facilitate change and exploration by questioning. Our own curiosity enables and empowers the listener to be even more curious about the structure of his or her own experience.

3) We coach best when we ask great questions that the person question finds exiting and powerful in answering.

In *Meta-Coaching* and *Neuro-Semantics,* we use several Questioning Models.

1) The Meta-Model of Language:

A way of communicating and questioning with the meta-representation system of language that allows us to expand our understanding of how language works and that empowers us to use *Representational Tracking* for more deeply and accurately understanding another.

In learning the Meta-Model, we will learn to identify linguistic distinction and to then questions those distinctions for greater communication precision. This will involve the skills of Meta-Model detection, questioning, and inductions.

2) Well-Formed Outcome Questions:

A set of questions designed to facilitate the creation of client outcomes or goals that are well-formed and that empower the client to begin the journey of personal development.

CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Epistemology: Sensory/ Intuitor: What is the source that you use when you gather information?

Scenario type: Best / Worse; Optimistic / Pessimistic. What aspect of information is focused on and attended to.

Philosophical: Why / How. Focusing on origins or solutions, on understanding or results.

Kind: Quantitative / Qualitative. Focus on numbers and measurement or on the nature of the experience.

Modus Operandi: Necessity, Desire, Possibility, Impossibility, Choice. Formatting the rules about how we move through the world.

***

THE META-MODEL

Do you know that there's magic in language?

Do you know that magic lies *the words* we speak and the symbols that we use to convey movies for the mind and frames for those movies?

The Meta-Model

- As a model, the Meta-Model is a set of linguistic distinctions and questions. The structural distinctions give us specific questions for exploring a person's experience.
- A description about the structure of language which enables us to think about the words we use everyday and the clarity (or lack of it) in the movies that it evokes in our minds.
- The Meta-Model describes the surface words and sentences that we utter and the deeper level meanings or references that they allude to. This gives us different *levels.* We have the level that's on the surface, and we have the level behind or underneath that gives us a fuller map of the person's meanings.
- By using the *distinctions* of the Meta-Model we can question linguistic and semantic structures that are not well-formed. Doing this elicits more well-formed expressions giving the speaker the opportunity to create a more complete mental map and mental movie. This enriches his or her inner world creating new capacities and skills. This is the "magic" of language and of the NLP communication model.

- What can we do with this model?
  1) Gather high quality information, gather more precise and accurate information.
  2) Hone in on the limits of the person's mental model of the world and identify precisely where and how a person has boxed him or herself in and how to expand that person's mapping.
  3) Clearly identify the techniques to use to positively influence someone.
  4) Invite the expansion of a person's mental mapping and therefore experiencing.

- *Language* as a mapping process only "makes sense" if it connects some movie for us or if we can use the words to create a movie in our mind. Communicating with

precision refers to being able to translate our higher level abstract words and concepts into more sensory specific referents so that the listener can create a similar picture.

- **Summary:**

  The Meta-Model is a model about language. The model is made up of *Distinctions* and *Questions.* As a model, it enables us to think about the form and structure of the language we use and the clarity of the movie that the words enable us to make. We use the Meta-Model to question ill-formed linguistic and semantic structures *so that* we can elicit from someone more well-formed expressions.

The Basic Meta-Model Questions for Precision

- How do you know?
- Says who?
- How specifically?
- When specifically?
- How does what I am doing cause you to ...?
- What would happen if you did or didn't?
- What stops you from ...?
- Compared to who or what?
- Does is always happen? What about Y event?
- What does that mean to you? What do you think that *is?*
- What are you assuming?
- How do you know that we should evaluate it as bad?

Representational Tracking

Representational tracking is the primary tool for using the Meta-Model effectively. This refers to the ability to *hear* statements and to take *only* what we hear and track it into the theater of our mind to create our representations of the other person's mental movie. If we can track from the word directly and immediately to our own internal movie and it makes sense, then the words are well-formed. If not, then the words are vague and fuzzy and we need to ask some questions about them in order to gather more information.

What happens when you representationally track the following statement.

> "Management has recently decided that it is required that the empowerment initiative begin by May 1."

What pictures and sound track did you create for your inner movie? Compare that with this one:

> "The brown dog ran across the green grass in the backyard chasing a brown rabbit who appeared suddenly from under a bush, and he ran across the cement that has only been set a few minutes before."

Do you have pictures of that? Did the movie begin playing almost as soon as you read the words?

- *Sensory-based words* enable us to track them directly from the page or from a speaker's mouth to our mental screen.
- *Evaluative words* that are non-sensory based invite us to either hallucinate or to ask for more precise information. If we do the later, we are meta-modeling.

As we step back, we can now explore the results of any given conversation to begin noticing if we communicate by hallucinating, jumping to conclusions, filling in the gaps, or if we ask questions to identify the speaker's messages and inner movie.

- How rich is my client's movie?
- What are the map rules for my client?
- Is there any value or fluffy process?
- What parts of their words do not allow us to create a clear representation?

Meta-Model Structuring and Modeling of Experience

As a model the Meta-Model identifies three central ways that we create our linguistic maps about things. We delete information, we generalize, and we distort. These are mapping or modeling processes. Accordingly, we organize the Meta-Model using these three processes.

- With *deletions* in our words and sentences, we seek out to fill in the details by asking questions that help us to paint a fuller picture of what the other person is saying.
- With *generalizations,* we will want to seek to explore the rules and conclusions to understand what they are and how they work, and how the person came to those generalizations.
- With *distortions,* we will seek to identify them and then to straighten out the distortions.

THE META-LEVELS OF LANGUAGE

The Meta-Levels

---------- Structure ----------

Metaphor (Met)
Presuppositions
Multi-Ordinality
Identification

-------- Distortion ----------

Mind-Reading
Complex Equivalences
Nominalizations
Cause-Effect
Lost Performatives
Delusional Verbal Splits
Pseudo-Words
Personalizing
Static Words

---- Generalization ------

Universal Quantifers
Model Operators
Either-Or Phrases
Over/Under Defined Terms

Evaluative Based Language

---Deletion---

Deletions -- Simple
Deletions—Comparative/ Superlative
(Unspecified Relations)
Unspecified Referential Indices
(Unspecified Nouns & Verbs)
Unspecified Processes —
Adverbs Modifying Verbs
Unspecified Processes —
Adjectives Modifying Nouns

Language

Sensory-Based

Descrip tive

Understanding the Magic

Questioning the Assumptive Structure

. Assumptive Formats or Frames
. Map-Territory Confusions

Questioning Distortions

. Specifying the knowledge source
. Specifying logical level confusions
. Specifying equations
. Specifying causations, syntax, order
. Specifying referents
. Hyphenating

Questioning Generalizations

. Challenging the Allness
. Challenging the Rules
. Challenging the One-Valued Structure
. Challenging the Two-Valued Structure
. Challenging the specificity

Indexing Deleted References

. Specifying the what, when, who, where, how, etc.
. Representationally Tracking referents

Sensory-Based Language

The Modeling Categories of the Meta-Model

Deletions	Generalizations	Distortions
Deletion: • About whom? • About what?	*Universal Quantifiers:* • All? Always? • For everybody? • Never? Nobody? • Is there never an exception?	*Cause and Effect:* How does X —lead to —>Y? • Causation terms: makes, forces, • Implied causation terms • Present tense verbs
Comparative Deletions • Compared to whom? • Greater than what?	*Modal Operators – Possibility* • Should • Could • Possible	*Mind-Reading* • How specifically do you know X about Y?
Unspecified Verbs • How specifically?	*Modal Operators— Necessity* • Have to • Must	*Complex Equivalence:* • An external behavior or action is equated to some internal state • EB = IS
Unspecified Nouns • What specifically? • Where? • When?	*Nominalization* A verb is turned into a noun Hiding the action in a static form • Can it fit into a wheelbarrow? • Put back into process form	*Presuppositions* • Linguistic assumptions • While, as, when, how • What has to be accepted as true to make sense of this? • What are you assuming?
Lack of Referential Index: • Who specifically? • What specifically?	*Lost Performatives* • Map-maker deleted • Over-generalized statement or judgment about life • Says who? When? • Under what circumstances?	*Delusional Verbal Splits* • How does “mind” work apart from “body?” • Isn’t it actually a time-space continuum?

	Either-Or Phrases • Is the situation really either/or? • Could it be both/and?	*Pseudo-Words* • What does X term actually refer to? • Isn't this term just noise or a spell-mark?
	Over/Under Defined Terms • What does this term mean by way of extension out into the real world? • Is this term over-defined in terms of mental intensions?	*Personalizing/ Identification* • How is it that you *are* X or Y? • Are you not identifying with and personalizing?
		Multi-Ordinality • At what level are you using this term? • What does this nominalization mean at X level of abstraction?
		Metaphor • How does this X relate to Y? • What comparisons are you making? • Where does the metaphor break down?

QUESTIONS AND EFFECTS

I. Patterns of Deletion:

Leaving features and characteristics out

Questions are asked to recover details that have been left out.

Specifically, what, when who, how, which etc?

1. Questioning Deletions	**Predictions/Results**
"They don't listen to me."	
Who specifically doesn't listen to you?	Recovers the Deletion
"People push me around."	
Who specifically pushes you?	Recover the Ref. Index
2. Questioning Comparing Deletions	
"She's a better person."	Recover the deleted standard, criteria, or belief
Better than whom? Better at what? Compared to whom, what? Given what criteria?	
3. **Questioning Nouns and Verbs**	
"I am uncomfortable."	Recover specific qualities of the verb
Uncomfortable in what way?	
Uncomfortable when?	
"They don't listen to me."	Recover the nouns of the person's involved.
Who specifically doesn't listen to you?	
Who specifically said that?	
"He said that she was mean."	Recover the individual meaning of the term
Whom did he say that you call mean?	
What did he mean by 'mean'?	
	Add details to the map
"People push me around."	
Who specifically pushes you?	
"I felt really manipulated."	
Manipulated in what way and how?	
4. Questioning Processes	
Adverbs modifying Verbs	
"Surprisingly, my father lied about his drinking."	Recovers the process of the persons emotional state
How did you feel surprised about that?	
What surprised you about that?	Enriches with details the person's referent
"She slowly started to cry."	
What indicated to you that her starting to cry occurred in a slow manner?	
5 Questioning Processes	
Adjectives Modifying Nouns	
"I don't like unclear people."	Recovers the projection of the speaker's sense of feeling "unclear" "unhappy"
Unclear about what and in what way?	
"The unhappy letter surprised me."	
How, and in what way, did you feel unhappy	

I. Patterns of Generalization:

Grouping details together to create a 'class' or 'category' where all subsets are ruled by the same values.

Questions are asked to challenge rules, beliefs, to discover processes and the identity of a source of information.

You have to? What would happen if you didn't?
Always? Never? Everybody?
How does that work?
How do you know? Says who?

1. Questioning Beliefs – (from Universal Quantifiers)

Allness, generalizations that exclude exceptions

"She never listens to me." Recovers details about the extent of a process and counter-examples
Never? She has never so much as listen to you even a little bit?

2. Questioning Rules (from Modal Operators)

An operational mode —one's *modus operandi*

"I have to take care of her." Recovers details of the process, also causes, effects, and outcomes
What would happen if you did?
What wouldn't happen if you didn't?
"I can't tell him the truth."
"You have to or else what?"

3. Questioning the Source of Info (From Lost Performatives and Mind Reading)

Evaluative statements with the speaker deleted or unowned

Assuming knowledge of another's internal feelings, thoughts, motives

"Its bad to be inconsistent." Recovers the source of information, specifies conclusions
Who evaluates it as bad?
According to what standard?
How do you determine this label?

"You don't like me."
How do you know I don't like you?
What evidence leads you to believe this?

II. Patterns of Distortion:

Experiences that have become limited by other linked and associated meanings.
Questions are asked to open new possibilities of meaning-
How does X lead to Y?
How do you equate these things?
What are your assuming?
What are you using to make this comparison?
To what degree? Is there nothing in between?

1. Questioning the Process (Nominalizations)

Processes transformed into static "things."
"Let's improve our communication."
Whose communicating do you mean?
How would you like to communicate?
"I woke up in a shocking state this morning"
How specifically did you feel, think, etc.?

Recovers the process and the characteristics left out. Specifies the verb

2. Questioning the Source of Information (from Cause = Effect Statements)

"He makes me angry"
How does his behaviour cause you to respond with angry feelings?
How specifically can he make you feel angry?

Recovers understanding of a persons point of view, causation, sources, and origins.

3. Questioning Meanings (from Complex Equivalents)

Phenomena that differ which someone equates as the same
"She's always yelling at me, so she can't like me"
How do you equate her yelling as meaning she does not like you?
Can you recall a time when you have yelled at somebody you liked or even loved?

Recovers how the person equates or associates ones thing with another

4. Questioning Assumptions (from Presuppositions)

"If my husband knew how much I suffered, he would not do that"
How do you suffer? In what way?
How do you assume that his intentions would shift if he knew?
Does your husband always use your emotional states to determine his behaviors?

Recovers a persons assumptions, beliefs, and values that he or she does not question.

5. Questioning Degree or Extent (from Either or Phrases)

"If I don't make this job work I will never be a success"
So you have no other alternative except total success or failure?

What steps are there in between?

Recovers the continuum, steps or stages deleted

6. Questioning Comparisons (from Stories)

"That reminds me of the time when Uncle Jim…"
How does this story relate to the point you want to make?

Recovers the relationship between the story and the persons concepts

Meta-Model Exercises

Precision Questioning

1) In groups of three, identify a limitation.

One person will think about an area of life wherein he or she experiences a limitation of some sort and describe it. One person will ask questions and support the experiencer. Another person will *record* the conversation to keep track of things.

2) Meta-Model the language.

After the person shares for 4 minutes, the others *meta-model* the statements *only* using Meta-Model questions. Especially inquire about nominalizations, cause-effect statements, and complex equivalences.

3) Debrief learnings and experience.

What distinctions were identified?
What Meta-Model questions were used?
What was the resulting response and the effect?

Beginning Meta-modeling

1) Create a list.

In your group make a list of 6 to 12 examples of each of deletions, comparative deletions, unspecified nouns, unspecified verbs, nominalizations, mind-reading, complex equivalences, modal operators, cause-effect statements.

2) Present.

Take turns delivering the ill-formed statements to the others letting the group practice *meta-modeling*.

3) Debrief .

Debrief after each speaker about what questions seemed most effective in gathering the highest quality information and effecting positive change.

Finding and Exposing Psychological "Can'ts."

1) Complete the following *sentence stems* with a list of 6 to 12 responses:

"I can't stand ...."
"What really gets me and rattles my cage is...."
"I feel most unresourceful when..."

2) Take turns reading the responses.

For example, "I can't stand it when someone talks to me with a harsh tonality."

3) Invite group members to respond with appropriate *meta-modeling challenges*.

For example, "What stops you from standing the other person's harsh tonality?"
"What would happen if you did 'stand' that person's unpleasant tonality?"

Precision Questioning for Empowering States

1) Identify an empowering state.

Describe a resource and/or resourceful state that you would like to have or to have more of (e.g. confidence, pose, self-affirmation, enthusiasm, love, energy, etc.). Describe this resource fully.

2) Meta-Model the state.

As the person offers their map of the resource, meta-model him or her to invite

a richer and fuller map of the experience. Continue until the person confirms that richer map.

3) Anchor the state.

As one of the members kinesthetically *anchors* this resourceful state, ask for *an auditory digital term* that summarizes it— "Confidence, joy, calmness, etc." Anchor repeatedly saying the term at the peak of the experience until just the word anchors it.

Running the Operational Levels on the Meta-model

1) Read the following list of statements to your group.

Then brainstorm to explore the Meta-Model violations that you find in it. List them.

2) Identify the highest level Meta-Model distinction that provides the most useful information or that provides the most leverage for change.

You always talk as though you're mad.
It's impossible for me to trust people.
My brother thinks our parents were abusive.
Everybody knows that you can't change a bureaucracy.
Communication is really hard for me.
Running away doesn't help.
I laughed at the irritating man.
Why do you always bring up such stupid examples?
Self-righteous people just burn me up.
The over-whelming price of food disturbs me.

Visiting the Land of Nominalizations

Identify the nominalizations in the following statements:

People always push me around.
Nobody pays any attention to anything I say.
I like friendly dogs.
I heard my mother in law yesterday gossiping about the neighbors.
One should always respect the feelings of others.
It's painful for us to see her like this, you know.
Let's not get bogged down in details.
There's a certain feeling in the room.
Everybody feels that way sometimes.

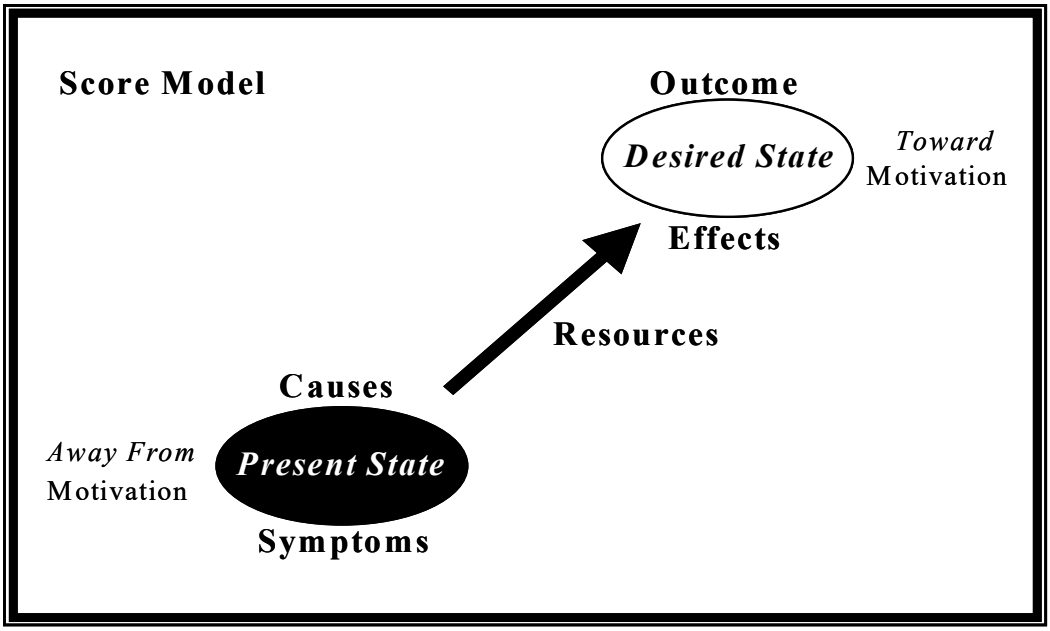
CORE COMMUNICATION COMPONENTS

Meta-Programs:

Goal Striving: Skepticism, optimizing, perfectionism. Formatting how one goes after goals and outcomes.

Motivation Direction: Toward / Away From; Approach / Avoidance. Formatting attention to one's direction as moving through the world. ***

WELL-FORMED OUTCOME PATTERN



To move to a well-formed outcome we gauge the distance and difference between present state and desired state. Where are we now? Where do we want to go? How can we get there? What stops us? What's in our way? This gives us a clear way to think more about moving away from aversions and toward desired outcomes. This pattern uses the key components for effectively creating and reaching a desired outcome. In coaching we use this pattern as a reference tool since it allows us to do several important things:

- By it we hand over responsibility to the client for his or her own plans and life.
- We set up milestones to measure and confirm progress.
- We set up a directional frame for Coaching.
- We set up a process that gives us and the client a leverage for change.

Criteria for a well-formed goal:

1) Stated and represented positively:

State what you want, not as what you do *not* want. Represent what you will be *doing* and *thinking*. Create a movie in your mind of life beyond or after the challenge or problem.

2) Sensory-based or empirical:

Stated in sensory based terms in the hear and now so that your internal movie will be close and immediate. Benchmark the specifics in see-fee-hear actions and behaviors.

3) Contextualized:

Describe the contexts of the outcome, when, where, with whom, how often, etc.

4) Forecasted in a time frame:

Locate on your time-line.

5) Actions steps and stages:

Represent the outcome in terms of processes, the specific steps and stages, and behaviors which will move you to achieving your goal. Use verbs rather than nouns and nominalizations.

6) Self initiated and maintained:

Describe the processes and behaviors that within your own control, that you can initiate and maintain.

7) Resources specified:

Describe the resources you will need to achieve your outcome, how will you do this?

8) Compelling:

Describe the outcome in language that you find compelling and motivating. Use the client's actual words and language.

9) Ecologically balanced:

Describe your outcome in a way that you recognize as balanced and ecological for all the contexts and relationships of your life.

10) Evidence procedure:

Identify an evidence procedure that will let you know when you have achieved your outcome.

The Pattern:

1) State the outcome in positive terms.

Where are you now? (Present State)
Where do you want to be? (Desired State)
What do you want in that desired state?
What do you want to positively achieve or experience?
What are you going toward?

2) Specify the outcome in sensory based terms.

What will you see, hear, feel, etc., when you have it?
What steps or stages are involved in reaching this outcome?
Have you used all of your senses in this description?

3) Identify the Contexts of this desired outcome.

Where, when, how, with whom, etc. will you get this outcome?

In what context or contexts is this outcome appropriate?
What are the most fitting and appropriate contexts for this outcome?

4) When will the future outcome occur on your time-line?

When do you expect to achieve this outcome?
How long will it take?
What will be the time stages along the way?
Is this time frame realistic and do-able?

5) Identify the steps and stages involved in reaching this outcome.

What are the steps involved in reaching this goal?
What are the stages involved?
Is this goal chunk down into small enough bits so that you feel that each piece is do-able?
Does the size of this outcome seem overwhelming to you at all?

6) Self-initiated and maintained.

Is the outcome something that you can initiate yourself and maintain?
Do you have it within your power and ability to reach this goal?
Is it within your control?
Can you initiate the actions to get started?
Can you maintain those actions or is it dependent upon what someone else needs to do?

7) Identify the resources you will need to achieve this outcome.

What resources will you need in order to get this outcome?
Who will you have to become?
Who else has achieved this outcome?
Have you ever had or done this before?
Do you know anyone who has?
What prevents you from moving toward it and attaining it now?

8) Make sure the outcome is compelling and motivating.

Is the outcome compelling?
Does it pull on you?
Will it get you up out of bed in the morning?
How much do you want this?
How much do you feel this as compelling from 0 to 10 if 10 is absolute?
How much do you need this to feel motivating?
What do you need to do to make it more sparkling for you?
What would make this really sparkle?

9) Quality Control the Outcome to make sure it is balanced and ecological.

Is the desired outcome ecological?
What will you gain through it?
What will you lose?
Is it achievable?
Does it respect your health, relationships, etc.?

Are there any parts of you that object to actualizing this desired outcome?

10) Evidence Procedure.

How will you know that your outcome has been realized?
What will let you know that you have attained that desired state?
How do you know when to exit?
When are you there?
When will you feel satisfied?

Getting a Well-Formed Outcome Statement

In coaching, we coach to an outcome. Without an outcome, we have no agenda or frame to coach to and so are doomed to merely having a nice chat! To create a true coaching session, we have to get an outcome statement from the client.

10. Evidence procedure
8. Compelling
9. Ecological
Realistic **---------- which I evaluate as fitting these criteria ---------**
/ \

Contextualized ---------- **in Z *(context)*** ----------
— where
— when / \

1. Stated in positive
5. Steps / Stages **---- I see, hear, and feel X as I *do* Y ----**
6. Self-initiated / \
2. Sensory-based

META-PROGRAM TEMPLATE

COGNITIVE Thinking	**EMOTIONAL** Feeling	**CONATIVE** Choosing	**SEMANTIC** **Meta** Meta-Programs
1. Representation: Visual, Auditory, Kinesthetic— Language	**19. Convincer Representation:** Looks right, Sounds right, Feels right — Makes Sense	**34. Convincer Demonstration:** Number of Times Length of Time	**48. Self-Experience:** Mind, Emotions, Will, Body, Roles, Dis-identified
2. Epistemological: Sensor — Intuitor Experiencing, Modeling Conceptualizing	**20. Movie Position:** Inside — Outside Stepping in— Stepping Out Associated feeling — Dissociated thinking	**35. Motivation Direction:** Toward— Away From Approach—Avoidance Attractions— Aversions	**49. Self-Instruction:** Compliant—Strong-Will Balanced
3. Scope: General global— Detail specifics Inductive — Deductive	**21. Exuberance:** Desurgency — Surgency Timid — Bold	**36. Organization Style:** Options — Procedures Alternatives — Sequential	**50. Self-Confidence:** Low — High Inbetween
4. Relationship Comparison Matching Sameness — Mismatching Difference Stability — Change	**22. Stress Coping:** Passive, Assertive, Aggressive	**37. Adaptation:** Judging — Perceiving Controlling — Releasing	**51. Self-Esteem:** Conditional — Unconditional
5. Information Staging: Foregrounding & Counting Backgrounding and Discounting	**23. Authority Source:** Internal –- External	**38. Modus Operandi:** Necessity, Desire Possibility, Choice Impossibility	**52. Self-Integrity:** Conflicted — Incongruity Congruent — Integrated
6. Scenario Type: Pessimistic — Optimistic Worst — Best Case Scarcity — Abundance	**24. Attention:** Self — Other	**39. Preference**: People, Place, Things, Activity, Information	**53. Responsibility:** Under-R. — Over-R. Healthy Responsibility
7. Classification Scale: Black-white, Either-Or — Continuum — Multi-Dimensionality **8. Nature:** Static — Process Aristotelian— Non-A.	**25. Em. Containment:** Uni-directional— Multi-directional	**40. Goal Striving:** Skeptic, Optimization Perfectionism	**54. Ego Strength:** Unstable and weak — Strong and Stable
9. Focus: Screening— Non-Screening	**26. Rejuvenation:** Introvert — Extrovert Ambivert	**41. Buying**: Cost, Quality, Time	**55. Morality:** Overly strong super-ego Strong super-ego Weak super-ego
10. Philosophical: Why (Origins)— How (Solutions) Understanding—Getting Results	**27. Somatic Response:** Reflective , Active Reflective, Inactive	**42. Social Convincer**: Distrusting Suspicious— Trusting Naive	**56. Self-Monitoring:** Low external—High Internal

11 . Communication: Verbal — Non-Verbal Digital — Analogue	**28. Social Presentation:** Shrewdly Artful— Artlessly Genuine	**43. Interactive:** Competitive—Cooperative Win/Lose — Win/Win	**57. Time Zones:** Past, Present, Future
12. Durability: Permeable — Impermeable	**29. Dominance:** Power, Achievement, Affiliation	**44. Directness:** Inferential — Direct High— Low Context	**58. Time Experience:** In Time — Through Time Random — Sequential
13. Causation: Causeless, Linear, Complex, Personal, External, Magical, Correlation	**30. Work Style:** Independent, Team Player, Manager, Bureaucrat, Follower	**45. Management:** Control, Delegate, Collaborative Flexibility	**59. Quality of Life:** Be — Do — Have
14. Completion: Closure — Non-Closure	**31. Change Adaptor:** Closed — Open Late—Medium— Early	**46. Risk Taking:** Aversive — Embracer Fearful — Excitement	**60. Values:** List of Values Nominalizations of what we believe as important
15. Information Kind: Quantitative— Qualitative	**32. Attitude:** Serious — Playful	**47. Decision Making:** Cautious — Bold	
16. Stream of Consciousness: Focused — Diffused In-between **17. Conventional:** Conformist — Non-Conformist **18. Speed:** Deliberate and Slow Witty and Quick	**33. Persistence:** Impatient — Patient		

Detecting Meta-Programs

Personal Preparation

- What are *the best states* to operate from so that we can communicate? Make a list of your best communication states.
- What are your best states for detecting and responding to meta-programs? Make a list of your best detection states.

Learning To Detect Patterns of Perception

- If meta-programs typically operate outside of our conscious awareness, **how** do we bring these programs into awareness?
- How can we become more aware of them?
- How can we learn to see the effect they have on the way we process information and interact with others?

Your Self-Preparation:

1) Turn up your reasons for paying attention.

If you had a way to detect, sort out, and pay attention to these meta-level patterns. ... If you could *consciously detect and track how any given person attends the world,* you would have a way to more effectively understand and even predict that person's style of hearing and responding to things. This would give you an awareness of that person's model of reality.

2) Access your best sensory awareness state.

Move into uptime with all of your sensory awareness fully present.

3) Access your best flexibility state.

Knowing another's model of the world *and* having the flexibility to alter your own behaviors and communications empowers you to meet that person at where they are. This way of connecting and matching creates *rapport* which reduces resistance, conflict, and misunderstandings.

What to do as a Practitioner:

(1) Assist the person into a more fully associated state.

The more one is in an experience, the cleaner the information we'll gather. Amplify that state when necessary and appropriate.

(2) Switch references.

Use the *Temporary Employment Frame:*

"If I were you for a day—how would I have to do that?"
"Teach me how to do that."

(3) Anchor the experience.

Do it without using the touch or kinesthetic system, focus on using your voice and gestures to anchor the experience.

(4) Slow the experience down and keep recycling.

Most subjective experiences go by too fast to catch all of the embedded patterns within it the first time. We see and hear much more when we see a fast-paced movie the second and third times.

Recycling through the experience with the person to gather more information.

(5) Invite the person to step into and out of the experience.

Watch the difference between when the person is associating into the experience and feeling it and when the person is not.

META-PROGRAM MASTERY

How can we develop mastering in detecting and using meta-programs?

1) Take each meta-program, *one at a time* and *practice each* one until you develop proficiency in recognizing and using it in speaking.

Refuse to overwhelm yourself with them.

2) Give yourself *permission* to hear structure and move out of content.

Go meta to listen for processing patterns. Does this make you self-conscious?

3) Use *open-ended questions* to elicit meta-programs.

"Would you tell me about one of your favorite holiday experiences?"

"What do you think about developing more effectiveness in communication skills?"

4) Some close-end question will work.

"Do you see this glass as half empty or half full?" can work well.

5) Use *downtime questions* to elicit meta-programs.

Any questions that requires a person to "go inside" to access the information which they need in order to respond. If they don't have the information "on the tip of the tongue," they will typically begin to also *demonstrate* their meta-program. And they *act it out* in various ways. So to elicit meta-programs simply ask a person to fully and completely recall something and have them then step into that experience and feel it fully as if there.

6) Remember, all meta-programs do *not* all carry the same or equal weight of importance.

They differ according to how a person uses and values them in a given task or area. Identify context, and then *Prioritize* them in terms of importance to that person.

"Which MP is most important and impactful for this person?"

"What MP exercises the most significance in this person's experiencing?"

7) Use the Sorting Grid to track the meta-programs (see *Figuring Out People* for the Grids).

This will help you organize them in your own thinking and memory.
Use it as a tool for profiling yourself first, then those you know well.

8) Practice writing *pacing statements.*
Use the information as soon as you can. Practice writing matching statements. This will greatly increase your communication skills.

If a person operates as a strong "self" sorter (Self Referencing) who mismatches with counter-examples (or with polarity responses), he will tend to feel inclined to challenge people with "Prove it to me!" statements. This can spiral into a pointless matching of wits if you don't watch out. Yet knowing this, we can now counter this internal formatting with a pacing statement like:

> "You seem so good at knowing your needs that only you can truly decide what you deem as ultimately right. No question about that. And I don't know if what I have to say will make any difference anyway. But anyway here it is."

META-PROGRAM EXERCISES

#1. **Eliciting a Positive Experience**

1) Elicit a positive experience from experiencer.
2) Groups of 3 invite the experiencer to talk about a positive event... tell about the experience when the person felt enthused, successful, brilliant, creative, decisive, a winner, etc.). Make sure the experience is a positive one.

3) Practitioners coach the experiencer in order to elicit more and more of the experience with questions.

4) After 5 minutes, have practitioners present the experiencer a summary of their "reading" of his or her meta-programs. Check with A to determine the accuracy.

#2. **The Sales Encounter**

1) Groups of 4. Person who begins identify something that he or she would "never, but never buy."

2) Person B will then attempt to sell that very item to Person A.
As B attempts this "sell," the first Person should essentially consistently respond with a gentle refusal, just saying "No." "Not interested."

3) Person B should forge ahead regardless of A's verbal and non-verbal resistance.

4) During this, the two meta-persons will be writing down all of the Meta-Programs they can detect in both persons.
Pay special attention in detecting the linguistic markers within the language patterns of the persons.

#3. **The Ideal Evening Game (Or, The Dating Game)**

1) When you are the Coach (or the Practitioner), ask open-ended questions of your partner (the Experiencer) which essentially inquire about what makes for a great night out.

"What would you want to know about a person before you ask him or her out?"

"What would you need to know to have an evening out with a good friend?"
"What would you evaluate as a delightful evening out with someone?"

2) Create a list of all meta-programs that you detect in the other person's responses.

#4. Asking for Favor

1) Set a frame or context so that the Practitioner will aim to persuade the Experiencer to do him or her a favor.

Ask an employee to do something... part of job or something extra.
Ask someone your in business with for a favor.

2) The Practitioner (or Coach) begins by asking ten questions of the Experiencer to identify his or her basic meta-programs.

Ask general, conversational question to gather this information.

3) After gathering MP information, Practitioner will then frame his request (evoking his desired outcome) in words that will reflect the Experiencer's most compelling Meta-Programs.

4) Feedback for refining.

Afterwards, invite the Experiencer to gauge the effectiveness of the request and to offer feedback about how it could be made even more personally compelling for him or her.

***#6.* The Experience of Liking**

1) Practitioner will elicit from the Experiencer a time when he or she liked someone upon first meeting that person.

"How did you decide that you liked that person?"

2) Use the Meta-Program sorting list, elicit as much information as possible about the Experiencer.

3) Repeat, doing the same for when the Experiencer disliked another person (a stranger, or now friend) upon first meeting him.

"How did you decide that you disliked that person?"

4) Meta Person will then feed back to Practitioner what he or she saw and heard and how the Experiencer responded in terms of meta-programs. Meta Person will also feed back to the Practitioner about how B displayed his or her own meta-programs in the process.

EXPANDING META-PROGRAMS

Meta-Programs inform our brain regarding *what to delete*

If we move Toward values, we delete awareness about what we move Away From.
If we sort for the Details, we delete the Big Picture.
Re-Direct awareness to what you normally delete, value that information, practice looking for it.

The beginning place for changing a meta-program is to consciously decide to do so.

1) Become aware of the meta-program.
2) Identify contexts where you want to use a different meta-program filter.
   Then check the ecology and value of the MP in those contexts.
3) Give your permission to try it on for a day.
   Do you have permission to shift it?
4) Shift your consciousness to the other side of the continuum as you try on the other MP.
5) Set multiple frames that will support using the preferred MP.
   What ideas or beliefs would support this filter?

CHANGING META-PROGRAMS

1) Identify and check the ecology of the meta-program filter.

When, where, and how do you use this meta-program which does not serve you well?
How does it undermine your effectiveness in some way?

2) Describe the preferred meta-program filter.

What meta-level processing would you prefer to run your perceiving and valuing?
When, where, and how do you want this meta-program to govern your consciousness?

3) Try it out.

Imaginatively adopt the new MP, pretend to use it in sorting, perceiving, attending, etc.
Notice how it seems, feels, works, etc. in some contexts where you think it would serve you better. Even if it seems a little "weird" and strange due to your unfamiliarity with looking at the world with that particular perceptual filter, notice what other feelings, beside discomfort, may arise with it.

4) Model it.

Do you know someone who uses this MP?
If so, then explore with that person his or her experience until you can fully step into that position. When you can, then step into 2nd perception so that you can see the world out of that person's meta-program eyes, hearing what he or she hears, self-talking as he or she engages in self-dialogue, and feeling what that person feels.
What's that like?

4) Run a systems check on the meta-program filter.

Go meta to an even higher level and consider what this MP will do to you and for you in terms of perception, valuing, believing, behaving, etc.
What kind of a person would it begin to make you?
What effect would it have on various aspects of your life?

5) Give yourself permission to install it for a period of time.

Do you have permission to shift to this meta-program filter?
What happens when you give yourself permission to use it for a time.?
Are there any objections?
Answer by reframing and then future pace.

If you have typically operated using the Other-Referencing meta-program and you give yourself permission to shift to Self-Referencing. Yet when you do, you hear an internal voice that sounds like your mother's voice in tone and tempo, "It's selfish to think about yourself. Don't be so selfish, you will lose all of your friends."
This voice objects on two accounts: selfishness and disapproval that leads to loneliness. So rephrase your permission to take these objections into account. "I give myself permission to see the world referencing centrally from myself—my values, beliefs, wants, etc., knowing that my values including loving, caring, and respecting others and that this will keep me balanced by considering the effect of my choices on others."

6) Future pace using the meta-program in specific contexts.

Practice, in your imagination, using the MP and do so until it begins to feel comfortable and familiar.

"If you knew when you originally made the choice to *operate from the Other Referent (name the meta-program you want to change)*, would that have been, before, after, or during birth?
Use one of the time-line processes to neutralize the old emotions, thoughts, beliefs, decisions, etc. The visual-kinesthetic dissociation technique, decision destroyer pattern, etc. Once you have cleared out the old pattern, you can install the new meta-program.

Day 3 Reflections

Reflection on your Day's Learnings, Discoveries, and Competencies:

- What magic did you discover in the structure of language via the Meta-Model?
- Were you able in the time devoted to set a Well-Formed Outcome for yourself?

- What do you now understand about *Meta-Programs* that you didn't know before?
- Did you discover any of your driving meta-programs?
- What Aha! insights did you have in exploring the whole subject of our perceptual filters?
- How well are you able even now to begin to profile your own perceptual filters?
- What did you learn about eliciting meta-programs and detect them in others?
- What ideas do you have about how this will enrich your communication and relationships skills?
- Do you understand how meta-programs arise from our coalesced meta-states?
- What did you discover in yourself when you used the Expanding Meta-Programs Pattern?

Marking and Measuring your Learnings and New Skills:

- What is the *one most important learning* that you want to keep with you for the rest of your life?
- Have you made any new empowering decisions about yourself or life? If you did, what would it be?
- How has your appreciation for NLP grown through this day?

APPENDICES

What are the roots of NLP? Where did the NLP Model and Movement come from? Who and what is a part of t he NLP heritage? Who gave birth to this movement and these models, and under what circumstances?

The Wild Days of NLP

1972 —1975:

Santa Cruz California: University of Southern California.
Richard Bandler transcribed audio-tapes of Fritz Perls for Dr. Robert Spitzer for *Science and Behavior Books.*
Richard held a Class on Gestalt Therapy with Frank Pucelik, later John Grinder became the faculty supervisor.
Richard went to Canada and recorded a Family Systems Seminar given by Virginia Satir.
Gregory Bateson's sponsorship at the University introduced Richard and John to Milton H. Erickson.
Group of experimenters: Robert Dilts, Judith DeLozier, Leslie Cameron, David Gordon, etc.

1975— 1979:

The Structure of Magic, I & II.
Patterns of the Hypnotic Language of Milton H. Erickson, I & II.
The Seminar Books by Steve Andreas: *Frogs, Reframing, Trance-formations, Using your Brain*.
NLP Society ... break up.

1980 — 1990:

Second generation Trainers and Developers —the splitting into different camps.
Sub-Modalities (1979 ... 1985)
Time-Line/s (1986)
Anthony Robbins (1986)
The New Code (1985, Grinder, DeLozer)
Bandler murder trial (1986-7)

1990 — 2000:

Bandler's DHE
Bandler's 90 million USA lawsuit (1995–1999), Fraud lawsuit in the UK.
Meta-States (1994)
Neuro-Semantics (1996)
Frame Games (1999)

2000 — 2010:

Matrix Model (2002)
Axis of Change and Meta-Coaching (2003)
Self-Actualization and Benchmarking models (2004)

The Crucible Model (2005)
Discovering of the Secret History of NLP

1936-1940 — Human Potential Movement

Abraham Maslow modeled two self-actualizing individuals: Max Wertheimer and Ruth Benedict. First Modeling Project of human excellence.

1941: Hierarchy of Needs Model

1954: *Motivation and Personality* published.

1960: Douglas McGregor, *The Human Enterprise,* Theory X and Y.

1962: Michael Murphy and Richard Price hear Aldous Huxley and purchase Esalen as the "mecca" of the Human Potential Movement.

1963: Fritz Perls moves to Esalen as the first Scholar-in-Residence.

1963: Gregory Bateson does workshop at Esalen.

1964: Virginia Satir moves to Esalen as the first Director of Training and Development.

1975: Bateson moves to Esalen as Scholar-in-Residence.

CHART OF THE HISTORY OF NLP ...

Pre-NLP
History

William James (1890)
Pavlov (1920s)

1933 1950 1956 1960 1972 1974 '75 '76 '78 '79

Korzybski *General Semantics*
"Neuro-Linguistic"
"Neuro-Semantic"
Design Engineering
1936-1938 Maslow *First Modeling* Project: Wertheimer, Benedict

Watzlawick *Linguistics*
Psychol.

Miller Pribram Gallanter Cognitive Movement Chomsky *Transformational Grammar*

Bateson *Frames* *Reframing* *Meta* *Logical Levels*

Bandler & Grinder *Meta-Model* *Structure Of Magic* *Submodalities*
1) Perls' *Gestalt*
2) Satir's *Family Systems*
3) Erickson's *Hypnosis*
Patterns I & II
Representation Systems
Eye Access.
Strategy Model
NLP enriched TOTE
Society of NLP

1980 '82 '85 '88 '90 '94

NLP, Vol I. Dilts, et. al.
Sleight of Mouth
Meta-Programs Leslie Bandler
Time-Lines
Meta-States

History of the NLP Models—

1975

1) "The meta-model of language in therapy" — the Meta-Model. 12 distinctions indicating ill-formed structure and 12 questions to elicit a more well-formed and fuller linguistic representation.
2) Representational Systems Model. They took the "model" of "the five senses" and asked the curious question— could it be that we represent information using these and that predicates indicate and sort out these five systems?
3) Eye Accessing Cue model. Listening to people use the Rep. Systems *and watching people* move their eyes, they asked, "Is there a pattern here?" What if there were correspondences between lateral eye accessing movements and use of the Rep. Systems?

1976

4) The Milton Model. Using these facets, Bandler and Grinder modeled the hypnotic patterns of Erickson and affectionately labeled the model, "The Milton Model."

1977

5) Strategy Model: using the TOTE model and enriching it with Rep. Systems, a richer model emerged from the Miller, Gallanter, Pribram TOTE model. They didn't create

this model, they enhanced an already existing model.

1978

6) Meta-Programs model. Are there patterns in information processing, sorting, and attending?

7) Sub-modalities or Pragmagraphics model. The distinctions and features of the Rep. Systems. Can we systematically order and structure these features and then use them for something? In revisiting this model, Bob Bodenhamer and I ended up re-modeling the so-called "sub-modalities" and created a new model about the features of the VAK (*The Structure of Excellence*, 1999). This then led to 6 new sub-models. We now know that these distinctions occur at a meta-level rather than at a supposed "sub" level, and that the model works "symbolically and semantically" rather than merely representationally. That is, a given distinction of a Rep. System works according to the *meanings* that a person attributes to it.

1979

8) Time-Lines. Is there a pattern in how people sort out and make distinctions within the concept of "time?" Inheriting the Temporal Model (Past, Present, Future), and based on the work by Edward Hall (no relation), NLP did not invent or create this model, but adapted and extended it (as with the strategy model). We now know that this model works at a meta-level and as a meta-state *about* ideas of "time." (*Time Lining or Adventures with Time-Lines,* 1998)

1980 to the Present

9) Specific models for specific outcomes. After NLP came up with this basic models—models that now define specific *domains of the field,* various people applied them and came up with smaller models, that is, specific models for specific outcomes. Some transpire and occur in a moment of time, others occur over a much longer period of time, from an hour to a day, to years.

Taking Criticism Positively
Naturally Thin Eating Strategy
Spelling Strategy
The Phobia Resolution Model
Motivation Strategy
Decision Strategy
Positive Parenting
Allegery Cure
Core Transformation Pattern

1994

10) The Meta-States model. Using the idea of logical levels found in Korzybski and Bateson, Meta-States emerged from finding the strict linear nature of the NLP enriched TOTE model ineffective and inadequate for following the strategy of complex states like resilience, proactivity, self-esteem, etc. Upon extending and enriching the Strategy model with meta-levels, Meta-States emerged as a model by bringing in system ideas from cybernetics, meta-cognition, reflexivity, etc.

1998

11) The Frame Games Model. Originally an attempt to "simplify" Meta-States and to put the meta-stating processes into a more user-friendly language. In that process we

happened upon the template of thinking about our states and embedded states-upon-states as Games driven by Frames. This has lead to seeing thinking not only as "representation" but as "referencing," and the levels of referencing as higher level frames.

2002:

The Matrix Model was developed from the work in Frame Games. *The Matrix Model* was immediately put to use as a template to gather and sort out information and then as a diagnostic tool for a person's frames, then later (2003) the Matrix Business Plan.
The Meta-Coach Training System (Hall and Duval).

2003:

The Axis of Change Model (Hall and Duval).

2004:

The Self-Actualization Quadrant, Model, and Matrix.

2005:

The Meta-Performance Model
The Axis of Leadership
The Stroke of Genius series

REPRESENTATION SYSTEM PREFERENCES

Read the following three descriptions of houses and notice the internal representations they evoke in you.

The first house is quite picturesque. It has a very quaint look to it. You can see that a lot of focus has been put on the colorful patio and garden area. It has a lot of window space so that you can sit in the kitchen and look adn enjoy a really nice view of the surrounding area. It's clearly a beautiful home.

The second house is soundly constructed. When you walk in the front door, the door closes with such a solid sound that you can hear its quality construction. It's in such a quiet area, in fact, that all you hear when you walk outside are the sounds of the birds singing. Its storybook interior tells of so much character that you'll probably find yourself saying to yourself that you would enjoy living here.

The third house is also solidly constructed and has a feel of warmth and comfort. It's not often that you come in contact with a place that touches on so many important features. It's spacious enough that you really feel like you can move around freely and yet cozy enough that you won't wear yourself out taking care of it.

- Which house most appeals to you?
- Which one evokes a fuller and more complete representation?
- How do you now feel if you were to discover that they are all descriptions of the same house, that the only difference is that each describes it to appeal to a different sense?

Read each of the following statements and place a number next to every phrase using the following system to indicate your preferences:

4 = Closest to describing you
3 = Next best description
2 = Next best
1 = Least descriptive of you

1. I make important decisions based on:

___ gut level feelings.
___ which way sounds best.
___ what looks best to me.
___ precise review and study of the issues.

2. During an argument, I am most likely to be influenced by:

___ a person's tone of voice.
___ whether or not I can see the person's argument.

___ the logic of the person's argument.
___ whether or not I feel in touch with the person's true feelings.

3. I most easily communicate what is going on with me by:

___ the way I dress and look.
___ the feelings I share.
___ the words I choose.
___ the tone of my voice.

4. It is easiest for me to:

___ find the ideal volume and tuning on a stereo system.
___ select the most intellectually relevant point concerning an interesting subject.
___ select the most comfortable furniture.
___ select rich, attractive color combinations.

5. I best operation or function as —

___ very attuned to the sounds of my surroundings.
___ highly adept at making sense of new facts and data.
___ sensitive to the way articles of clothing fit on my body.
___ having a strong response to colors and to the way a room looks.

For Scoring—

1) Copy your answers to the sequences listed here:

1.	__ K	2.	__ A	3.	__ V
	__ A		__ V		__ K
	__ V		__ A_d		__ A_d
	__ A_d		__ K		__ A
4.	__ A	5.	__ A		
	__ A_d		__ A_d		
	__ K		__ K		
	__ V		__ V		

2) Add the numbers associated with each letter. There are 5 entries for each letter.

Visual — Auditory — Kinesthetic — Language (A_d)

1

2

3

4

5

Totals:

3) The comparison of the total scores in each column will give a relative preference for each of these four major RS.

Calibrating dropping a Dollar Bill:
1) In groups of three, person 1 begin by holding a dollar bill at waist level.

2) Person 2 encircle the dollar bill with the hand about mid way up and ready to catch the dollar bill when Person 1 drops it.

3) Calibrate each time 1 drops the dollar bill until #2 figures out Person 1 unconscious movements, etc, prior to dropping the dollar bill. Look for the unconscious signals of that person before dropping the dollar bill.

4) When person #2 catches the dollar bill three times in a row, you know you have determined Person's 1's pattern. #2 notices what he or she has calibrated to regarding the dropping of the dollar bill. Feed back to 1 sensory based descriptions of the unconscious movements detected.

Representational System Practice

Genie Laborde *(Influencing With Integrity)* a handy instrument for determining one's preferred representation system. Use it to determine which system you most prefer, prefer secondarily, and which one you do not consciously use very much. The system that gives you the most difficulty to translate and match probably reflects your least used system.

1) My future looks hazy.

Match:

Visual: When I look to the future, it doesn't seem clear.

Translate:

Auditory: I can't tune in to my future.

Kinesthetic: I can't get a feel for what seems to be going to happen.

2) Sarah doesn't listen to me.

Match:

Auditory: Sarah goes deaf when I talk.

Translate:

Visual: Sarah never sees me, even when I'm present.

Kinesthetic: I get the feeling Sarah doesn't know I'm alive.

3) Mary gets churned up on Mondays when the boss expects the report.

Match:

Kinesthetic: Mary gets agitated and nervous on Mondays.

Translate:

Visual: Mary can't focus on Mondays when the report comes due.

Auditory: Mary hears lots of static on Mondays when the report comes due.

Complete the following to increase your awareness of the representational systems. This will offer you good practice for future use. This exercise will wire your mind to match predicates when you next hear one of these.

1. My boss walks over me like I'm a door mat.

   Match:
   Translate:
   Translate:
   Translate:

2. I get the feeling I'm unappreciated.

   Match:
   Translate:
   Translate:
   Translate:

3. I have trouble looking back to that problem.

   Match:
   Translate:
   Translate:
   Translate:

4. I guide this project by the seat of my pants.

   Match:
   Translate:
   Translate:
   Translate:

5. She seems like such a sweet girl.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

6. I ask myself, "How did I ever get into this?"
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

7. I can imagine what she's like.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

8. Something tells me I'm making a mistake.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

9. I've tried to get a handle on what my boss means.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

10. I keep stubbing my toe on unexpected obstacles.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

11. Joe paints a clear picture of disaster ahead.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

12. Smells like a dead fish to me.
Match:
Translate:
Translate:
Translate:

The 26 Core Coaching Skills of Meta-Coaching—

The 7 Essential or Core Coaching Skills

We benchmark the first skills during *Coaching Mastery* for the ACMC credentials

There are **7 core coaching / communication skills—**seven skills *essential* to the heart of coaching. These serve as the foundation for all of the additional and advanced skills. Without these a person cannot effectively coach. These are essential to the heart of being a professional communicator.

After these, there are 9 communication/coaching skills for facilitating *change* around the four axes of change (the Axes of Change model) and 10 advanced communication/coaching skills for a total of 26 coaching skills for the Meta-Coach.

Change Skills in the Coaching Dance

1) Awakening
2) Challenging
3) Provoking
4) Probing: Questioning and Meta-Questioning
5) Co-Creating: Framing, Deframing, Reframing
6) Actualizing
7) Reinforcing / Celebrating
8) Testing
9) Facilitating

We highlight these during the ACMC Meta-Coach training but do not benchmark them as prerequisite competencies. We do that for the PCMC credentials.

Critical Coaching Skills

1) Framing and Reframing
2) Tasking
3) Cheerleading and validating
4) Holding Accountable/ Monitoring
5) Pattern Detection
6) Stepping Back
7) Profiling
8) Modeling
9) Benchmarking
10) Lightening up and humorizing
11) Storytelling and metaphor-ing
12) Recognizing coachable moments
13) Tracking a client's experience

We benchmark these skills during the MCMC training for those moving on to the Master Coach level.

SYNOPSIS OF CONTENT

Day 1: Listening and Support

Design: To delve into the core ingredients of communication excellence to develop high quality listening skills, awareness skills, and "presence" skills in order to truly support another person is in the coaching relationship.

Outcomes:

- To learn the basic features of the Neuro-Linguistic Communication Model
- To learn to stop one's own internal chatter, judgments, and filters and "come to one's senses" in being present to another person.
- To learn how to detect the states and internal experiencing of another person.
- To learn about the mapping and movie-making inside our minds as we "make sense" of information.

Day 2: Questioning and Eliciting States

Design: To explore the basic structure and process of questioning, precision questioning, and solution oriented questioning, to explore how to use words for linguistically mapping out our sense of the world, the movies that we play in our mind, and to send messages to our bodies about how to feel those meanings and to explore how to to work with our states and the states of another.

Outcomes:

- To learn the key linguistic distinctions that govern the way we map things inside our minds.
- To learn how to ask exploring questions that create more precise and fuller communications.
- To learn how to representationally track from words to the inner movies of our mind.
- To learn how to use questions powerfully for expanding awareness and for inducing more resourceful states.
- To learn how to access and anchor a basic mind-body state.

Day 3: Detecting Perceptual Patterns

Design: To explore and learn the Meta-Programs model so that we can listen for the structure of thinking and information process, to explore a format for detecting patterns, identifying perceptual filters, and using them to support our clients.

Outcomes:

- To discover the template of meta-programs that create our perceptual filters.
- To develop some basic skill in recognition and use of the meta-programs.
- To develop an appreciation of their value and importance and how to use them in communicating more effectively and pursuasionally.

Day 4: Setting Frames and Meta-Questioning

Design: To delve into the Meta-States model to understand how we layer frame upon frame to create our matrix of frames, and how each meta-stating jump creates a new psycho-logical level of the mind, and textures our primary states in a systemic way.

Outcomes:

- To discover the power and usefulness of Meta-States as a model of reflexivity.
- To develop skill and practice in the process of meta-stating to communicate and set new frames.
- To self-communicate and set executive frames for greater resourcefulness and personal state management.
- To induce the most resourceful states for myself and others by using the frame-setting power of meta-states.

- To texture our states with resourceful qualities and to create richer and more complex states.

Day 5: Receiving Feedback for Mastery

Design: To move beyond simple meta-stating of Day 4 to complex meta-stating as we explore our semantic and conceptual states especially around emotions and concepts. Applying these to the core coaching skill of *receiving feedback* to slay or tame any "dragons" (unresourceful states). Then using the mind-to-muscle Meta-State pattern for coaching the body how to feel great ideas.

Outcomes:

- To accept and appreciate all emotions as emotions.
- To meta-state (frame) concepts so that they serve us rather than sabotage.
- To tame or slay any "dragon" states that undermine mastery and success.
- To coach the body to feel our highest ideals and semantic concepts.
- To step out into a mental-emotional space for creative thinking.
- To develop the core coaching skill of effectively receiving feedback.

Day 6: The Focus of Authenticity

Design: To identify, energize, and use our highest intentionally as a coach to step in and out of the *coaching genius state* at choice, to set intentions that can align our everyday attentions and to create states of focused engagement ("genius" or "flow" states) which enhance our emotional intelligence.

Outcomes:

- To align attentions to intentions and create greater executive power.
- To create a genius state of engagement and presence.
- To align oneself to create more congruency and integrity.
- To blow out excuses and stop selling ourselves short.

Days 7-14: Coaching Mastery

Design: To delve into *the Axes of Change model* for communicating and coaching change in oneself or another; to explore and develop skill with *the Matrix model* for understanding all of the embedded frames we have built developmentally as we have grown up, and to more fully identify and use the premises and principles of self-actualizing psychology. To benchmark each and every skill and to learn the benchmarking process itself (*The Benchmarking model*) that enables us to quantify these high quality experiences. To learn and use the *Self-Actualization Quadrants* and *Matrix.*

Outcomes:

- To learn and explore all seven of the models governing the Meta-Coach Training System to have a systematic methodology for coaching, enabling the coach to know *what* to do *when* with *whom* and *why.*
- To begin using the models in extended and intensive coaching practices.
- To give and receive high quality feedback that is sensory specific and that facilitates the ongoing development of another.
- To learn how to dance with the process of change through the axes of change and to develop skill as a change agent.
- To be benchmarked on the 7 core coaching skills and to receive certification as a Meta-Coach (ACMC credentials) which begins the pathway to being a professional coach (PCMC).

THE DEVELOPERS AND TRAINERS OF THE META-COACH TRAINING SYSTEM

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

Michael first applied NLP to Coaching in 1991 with his *Empowerment Coaching* which was designed to empower business managers and owners. As that stimulated an interest in resilience as a key factor of personal success and effectiveness, it led to his modeling project on *Resilience*. In the midst of modeling resilience, Michael developed *the Meta-States model* which became the foundation for the field of Neuro-Semantics. This took his mind away from coaching for several years. Then in 2001 Michael began researching and modeling the emerging field of Coaching and created the first Meta-Coach Certification training in November 2003, Sydney Australia.

Having met three truly awesome coaches who had become Neuro-Semantic trainers, Michelle Duval, Graham Richardson, and Cheryl Gilroy, Michael invited them to be the expert coaches at the first Meta-Coach Training and to offer whatever input they would like. Later Michael invited Michelle to join him in more fully developing Meta-Coaching. As a modeler and researcher, Michael's creative genius lies in that of synthesizing materials and seeing patterns, and as a visionary leader in NLP and Neuro-Semantics that of awakening people to an exciting vision about what's possible.

Michelle Duval, Master Coach

When Michelle started as a coach, she thought that she had invented the phrase "Life Coach" as she prepared to leave the marketing company she had been working for. Having had a passion for self-development and experience as a manager in the hotel business, Michelle had a natural gift for empowering people in finding their gifts, values, and passions. Her discovery of NLP and then of the Meta-States model equipped her further and she launched *Equilibrio—Actualising Individuals and Organisations* in Sydney Australia. In 2000 she was the co-chair of the Sydney branch of the International Coaching Federation (ICF). Michelle is a renown public speaker and has presented at many conferences, including the ICF. She was at the first Meta-Coach Training as both a participant and Expert Coach, then joined Dr. Hall to co-develop the Meta-Coach Training System 2003-2007.

Meta-Coach Trainers

These are Neuro-Semantic trainers certified as Meta-Coaches (ACMC) who have been Team Leaders and have shadowed the Meta-Coach Training System and then licensed. The license has to be renewed every three years:

- David Murphy — Mexico
- Mandy Chai — Hong Kong and China
- Ivan Robbles — Mexico
- Mohamed Tarek — Egypt

Those in the internship process in 2011:

- Germaine Rediger — Belgium
- James Hayes — Sydney, Australia
- Omar Salom — Columbia and Mexico

TRAINING OBJECTIVES

Our primary goal in **Coaching *Essentials*** is to learn the NLP Communication model and the basics for running our own brain as the first model of the ACMC credentials. The purpose of this is to take charge of our own experiences and to manage our own states so that we begin from a most resourceful place.

1) *Sensory awareness for calibration (Listening skill)*
   To notice, be aware of, detect the patterns and processes of the person with whom we are communicating.

2) *Pacing and matching for rapport (Support skill)*
   The skills that enable us to connect with another person, enter his or her world, and to create a sense of trust using listening and confirmation skills.

3) *Questioning skills (Questioning and Meta-Questioning skills)*
   The skills for exploring with another person what they really think and feel about something, to understand where the other is coming from, and to accurately represent them.

4) *Eliciting and anchoring states (State Induction skill)*
   The skills for working with a person's state of mind-body-emotion to invite the person to call forth or evoke the best and most resourceful states and then to anchor them so that the person has more control over those states.

5) *Pattern detection (an advanced Coaching skill)*
   The skills that enable us to recognize patterns in the person with whom we communicate, as well as our own, so that we can then choose how to more effectively "run our own brain."

6) *Step back skills (inherent in the Meta-State model)*
   The beginning skill of stepping back from our first-person perceptual position and to gain a larger perspective, to develop more mindfulness, and to expand our ability to choose our own way.

7) *"Apply to Self" for personal congruency (inherent in the Neuro-Semantic approach)*
   We learn best when we experience or apply the learnings to ourselves. Inasmuch as these models are experiential, we best learn them by experiencing them. Set the frame that you will *apply to self* so that what you learn will become *action*. Are you coachable? How coachable are you? What do you need to apply to self so that you can take your own skills and performance to the next level? Self-coaching is the ultimate skill.

Sub-skills & Benchmarks of the 7 Core Competencies

SUPPORT

			Sets Frames		Id. Patterns
			Summarizes – Celebrates; Commitment		
Interrupts	Fidgeting	Partial matching	Matches verbally – Acknowl.	Confirmation	
Judges	Dis-validates	Ignores	Matches physiology		Confrontation
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**	**3**	**3.5**

1) Manages the physical environment eliminating distractions.
2) Calibrates and matches physiology, postures, gestures
3) Matches words, voice, tempo, volume
4) Matches meta-programs, meta-states, values, beliefs
5) Matches the speed of client and giving time to process
6) Acknowledges what client says and feels
7) Confirms the client, recognizes his or her "state," validates the person.
8) Summarizes 1 or more minutes in one or two lines.
9) Sets frames that help create an environment/context
10) Languages (put into words) emotions, gestures, physiology
11) Celebrates strengths, positive facets in client
12) Identifies patterns the client demonstrates in words/actions
13) Expresses commitment to the client
14) Confronts the client on blind-spots, and when the client avoids, denies, fails to respond, or responds in a way that undermines the outcome.

LISTENING

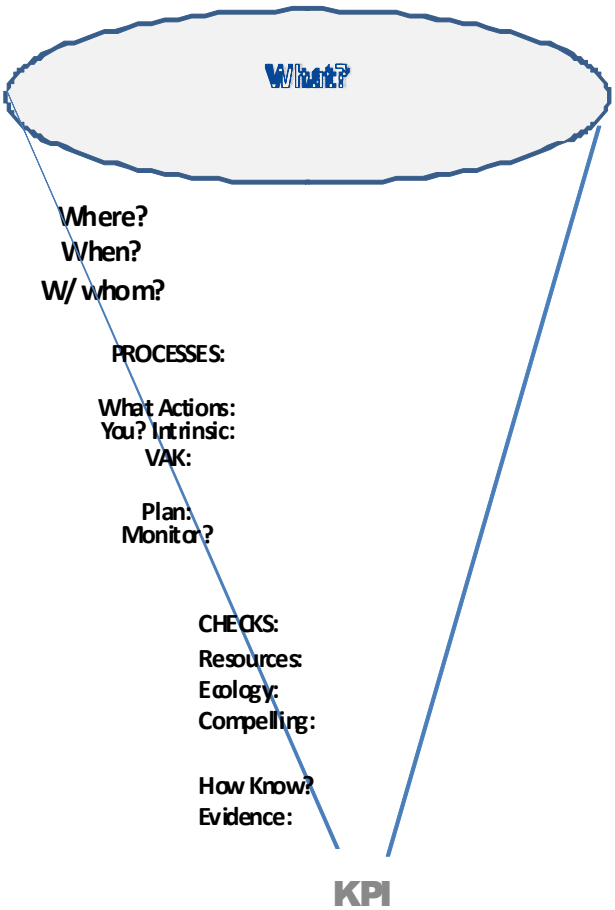
			Signals for talking	Silence	
Interrupting	Misses Points		**%** Talk Clarity Q.	Invites self-listening	
Talking over	Mind-reading	Insufficient	Repeats words – Mirrors	Awareness Q.	
Telling	Distracted	Paraphrasing	Eye contact	Tracks	Asks what not said
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**	**3**	**3.5**

1) Looks at the client, makes eye contact
2) Gives more time to client for speaking (60/40 or 70/30)
3) Signals client to talk via sounds, nods, words
4) Repeats the words precisely
5) Tracks words and gestures over the time.
6) Checks for clarity, asks about the meaning of words.
7) Invites the client to attend to and listen to self, invites self-listening
8) Feeds back the client's words and gestures to provide a mirror so client can "see" him or herself.
9) Asks about what's not been said
10) Silent after person finishes speaking to give a moment for reflecting.

QUESTIONS

Judges	Rhetorical Un-useful Leading Tells	Too few — Stories	WFO Q. Inquires	Innocent Q. Quality Control Testing Q. Pauses	Indepth Exploration Q. Semantic loaded **KPI**	
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**		**3**	**3.5**

1) Inquires about inner thoughts, feelings, needs, fears, hopes.
2) Ends sentence with a tone that goes up.
3) Raises eyebrow, opens eyes wider, pauses for a response.
4) Phrases inquiries to engage client to explore what's relevant to outcome.
5) Co-creates a clearly defined outcome (KPI).
6) Asks about the client's values and ecology ("quality control").
7) Tests client's decision, understanding, clarity.
8) Determines if word or event is "semantically loaded."
9) Asks without assuming you already know (Know-Nothing, Innocent Questions)



META-QUESTIONS

			1 per 2 min.	Layers Q.	
		Too few	Id. Levels	3* Levels	
	Irrelevant	Incongruent	Inquires @ meta-levels	Grounded	FBI Q.
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**	**3**	**3.5**

1) Congruently inquires without hesitation.
2) Inquires about second, third level, etc. thinking of client's outcome (Relevant).
3) Repeats the client's experience and inquires about thinking and feelings (Grounded).
4) Identifies two or more levels of ideas about an experience, asks about such ("detect frames presented").
5) 1 Meta-Q every two minutes to inquiry into the self-reflexive thoughts and feelings ("meta-levels").
6) Layers multiple levels into the inquiry (Complex).
7) Introjects premises into an inquiry that presuppose what the client wants (frame by implication questions, FBI). Uses "language patterns" that phrases thinking in layers to presuppose the client's "values," "outcomes," dreams and "states" that the client has said he or she wants.
8) Probes into three or more "layers" of thoughts in the back of the mind ("indepth exploration")

STATE INDUCTION

			Names		
		Insufficient	Voice # of attempts	Coaches body	
	Incongruent	Avoids	Triggers	Induction	
	Monotone	Rushes	Addresses Silence Meta-Q Menu		
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**	**3**	**3.5**

1) Speaks about mind-and-body "states" (thoughts and feelings) that client experiences or wants (Addresses).
2) Refers to "experiences" or events that call forth feelings (Triggers).
3) Uses voice, gestures, etc. that increases the likelihood of evoking the experience.
4) Repeatedly attempts to elicit the embodied experience (5 or more attempts).
5) Names an experience as a "state."
6) Uses silence to allow a client time to experience a state.
7) Asks meta-questions that presuppose the accessing of a state.
8) Provides a menu list of choices of possible ideas for evoking a state.
9) Uses "the language of induction" (hypnotic language patterns).
10) Asks client about his or her breathing, muscle tension, facial expressions, voice, etc. in order to feel an idea or experience ("coaching the body").

GIVING FEEDBACK

		Evaluative			Next Step	
		Vague			Checks	
Attack	Mind-reading	convoluted	Client's Ref.	Tentatively	Relevance	
Judgment	Argue	Self-Criteria	Rapport	Timely	Sensory-based	
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**		**3**	**3.5**

1) Matches an experience in words, gestures, tone, volume, etc. seen or heard to mirror back.
2) Uses client's outcome as point-of-reference.
3) When using a benchmark, mentions the number of the level.
4) Speaks in sensory-based terms.
5) Speaks shortly after the event—ideally within minutes (timely).
6) Offers comments tentatively, owns them as one's own (tentative).
7) Gives response that relates to what the person says is important to self ("relevant").
8) Asks client if the mirrored response seems accurate and valid (checks)
9) Offers suggestions for a next step for improving skill ("actionable").

RECEIVING FEEDBACK

				Appreciation	
	Discount	Explains	Acknowledge	Means to you?	
Walks away	Argue	Disagree	Calm	Sensory evidence	Implements
Disengaged	Talks over		Silent reflection	Inquires about	Uses
0	**1**	**2**	**2.5**	**3**	**3.5**

1) Calibrates to the presence of a response in another.
2) Silently reflects on the information presented.
3) Breathes deeply in listening and acknowledging ("stays calm").
4) Acknowledges the information given.
5) Inquires about the experience of an event or a statement.
6) Asks about the sensory evidence regarding the information or response offered.
7) Explores what the words means to the other person.
8) Expresses appreciation for the information given.
9) Uses and implements to make a change in your talk, tones, gestures, behaviors, and actions.

The Most Impact in Communication:
Verbal or Non-Verbal Channels?

EXPOSING THE OLD NLP MYTH

I first read the following article by "Buzz" Johnson in 1994 in *Anchor Point,* An NLP Journal. Having worked in communications as a trainer and therapist I knew that the old statement that 93% of communication is non-verbal was wrong. I knew that from watching and trying to understand movies on planes when I didn't buy the headphones. Watching faces wasn't enough. When the movie was in a foreign language, I'd get more of a sense of when the actors were angry, upset, in love, etc. But that was about it.

This article confirms the fact that most *information* which we receive from each other in our communications is *not* non-verbal information and *not* conveyed by the non-verbal channels of tone, facial expressions, or body "language." No. It is rather our meta-representational system of language that allows us to convey most of the information in our lives. Try to "say" (send the informational content) that "Supper will be ready at 5:45 p.m." with just some tones, facial expressions, or body gestures! This highlights the crucial role that the higher linguistic systems play in our lives. We need *words* to convey higher level as beliefs, concepts, understandings, ideas, plans, meanings, etc. So while primary states are valuable and important, meta-states are much more so. They truly govern our experiences inasmuch as they set the conceptual and semantic frames that we live in. Enjoy.

L. Michael Hall

THE 7%, 38%, 55% MYTH

Dr. C. E."Buzz" Johnson

In the remote sense that anyone in the NLP field needs their memories refreshed concerning the numbers in the above title, let me briefly give my recollection from numerous sessions. The total message one receives in any face to face communication is divided into three components. The words themselves, the tonality used in delivering those words, and the body language accompanying the other two.

The numbers indicate the relative weight or importance assigned to each of these three areas with body language receiving the 55% figure, tonality the 38%, and the actual words themselves being tagged with a paltry 7%. This strangely skewed distribution has bothered me ever since my introduction into this marvelous arena called NLP.

Out of the Mist

The first reason for my puzzlement was that none of my NLP instructors could tell me where those figures came from. Please do not interpret this to mean that I had been cursed with unknown and unknowing fly-by-night mentors. They are all very well known and active in the NLP community. They are also, in my opinion, excellent teachers. However, when asked where I might find further information about the research that produced those numbers, I was vaguely referred to a variety of well known universities. I later drew a blank at each of these institutions.

Secondly, if these percentages are really valid it would mean that the learning of foreign languages could be greatly abbreviated. After all, if the words only account for 7% of the meaning of communication, we should all be able to go to any country in the world, and simply by listening to the tone and carefully observing the body language, be able to accurately interpret 93% of their communications**!** And I'll bet you always thought that learning Chinese or Russian would be a real stretch. In fact, from these percentages, it appears that you needn't even bother. You may be better off without being encumbered by all the intricacies of any language. People like Leo Buscaglia are looking forward to the time when words will no longer be necessary as he states in his book *Living, Loving & Learning.* Since a word such as "love" has as many definitions as it has definers, he feels it will be a happy day when the world of word hang-ups is replaced by "vibrations."

Counting on What?

I wonder how many of you have a 93% rate of accuracy when it comes to interpreting and understanding even your most intimate friends and family members? And that's with people speaking the same official language with its 7% impact!

It is not only the NLP community that is espousing and apparently believing the 7-38-55 myth. I've heard therapists and counselors who were unfamiliar with NLP allude to those same numbers. There also seems

to be a widespread believe among the general population that words are relatively unimportant. I'm sure most of us have heard people mid-read with statements such as, "She didn't really mean what she said, she probably meant XXX instead." Or, "He may have said that but he didn't really mean it." Or, "It's not what you say, but how you say it."

In NLP change work, note how carefully we re-word statements in order to reframe a client's personal perceptions. And by very skillfully using just the right hypnotic language patterns, we are able to rapidly enhance desired shifts in our clients' understandings and attitudes and beliefs. Would we need to be this meticulous and conscientious if we were really dealing with only 7% of a person's awareness and comprehension?

I was finally able to track down the source of this myth thanks to a professional speaker who makes his living giving sales seminars and workshops. And yes, the 7-38-55 was an important part of his presentations. He didn't know how to spell the name of the individual responsible for the research that originated those numbers or which university was involved, but he gave me a valuable starting point by offering me a couple of different possible pronunciations. I think you'll be interested in what I found.

The Study

Albert Mehrabrian, Ph.. Of UCLA was the originator of the 7-38-55 theory. He speaks of it in two books, *Silent Messages* published in 1971, and *Nonverbal Communications* published in 1972. In these two books, he refers to research projects which were published in various professional journals. I will get to the journals in more detail later, but first let's look at some of his statements from one of the books.

From Chapter 3 of *Silent Messages* we find that the numbers 7-38-55 expressed as percentages have to do only with what he calls the resolution of inconsistent messages, or to put it in NLP terms, incongruencies. He also states that there are very few things that can be communicated non-verbally. He initially was investigating liking/ disliking which he later generalized into feelings. In speaking with him by phone in March, 1994, he stated that his findings and inferences were not meant to be applied to normal communications. They were of very limited application.

Let me paraphrase some of his thoughts from page 134 toward the end of that book. Clearly, it is not always possible to substitute actions for words and therefore, what are the limitations of actions as instruments of communication? If you've ever played charades, you know that words and language are by far the most effective way of expressing complex and abstract ideas. The ideas contained in *Silent Messages*, and most other books for that matter, couldn't be done with actions. A very important thing to remember about the differences between words and actions is that actions only permit the expression of a limited set of things; namely, primary feelings and attitudes.

The Details

Now let's examine in more detail the specifics of a couple of his experiments from which some people have made some rather sweeping and inaccurate generalizations. From the *Journal of Consulting Psychology,* 1967, Vol. 31. No. 3, pg. 248-252 is a report entitled Inference Of Attitudes From Nonverbal Communication In Two Channels. This study was designed to investigate the decoding of inconsistent and consistent communications of attitude in facial and vocal channels. The experimental team found that the facial component received approximately 3/2 the weight received by the vocal component. You can readily see that this roughly corresponds to the 38% and 55% figures mentioned earlier.

You may be wondering how this study was conducted. There was only one word used. That word was "maybe," selected for it's apparent neutrality. Three female speakers were tape recorded saying that word wile varying their tone of voice so as to communicate three different attitudes (i.e., like, neutral, and dislike) towards an imagined addressee. Then the tapes were listened to by 17 female subjects with instructions to imagine that the speaker is saying this word to another person and judged by the tones what the speaker's attitude is towards that imaginary addressee. So there was no direct feedback by anyone who was being addressed. It was a number of third-party listeners who were asked to mind-read, guess, interpret, imagine, etc., how the speaker felt towards someone who wasn't even there and, in fact, didn't even exist. There was no way to see or hear the reactions of this phantom individual, about whom someone was going to make several long-lasting and powerful speculations.

Next, black and white photographs were taken of three female models as they attempted to use facial expressions t communicate like, neutrality, and dislike towards another person. Then photos were shown to the same 17 subjects with the instructions that they would be shown the pictures and at the same time hear a recording of the word "maybe" spoken in different tones of voice. "You are to imagine that the person you see and hear (A) is looking at and talking to another person (B)." For each presentation they were

to indicate on a rating scale what they thought A's attitude was toward B. Again, third-party mind-reading with no direct contact with the person addressed, B, because that person was non-existent. The conclusions from this experiment were that the facial components were stronger than the vocal by the ratio of 3/2 as referred to earlier.

An interesting comment that came out of the discussion section indicated that the effect of redundancy (i.e., consistent attitude communication in two or more channels) is to intensify the attitude communicated in any one of the component channels. Perhaps this is something that could be more profitably pursued instead of the denigration of words. Or as you can see from this particular study, word, not words. And that word was "maybe." It seems to play words under quite a handicap not much different from playing charades.

Two Studied Combined

They integrated this study with another one to come up with the .07, .38, and .55 coefficients. This second study was reported in the *Journal of personality and Social Psychology*, 1967, Vol. 6, No. 1, pg. 109-114 entitled, *Decoding Of Inconsistent Communications.* Here they dealt with inconsistent communication of attitude in two components; tone of voice and nine different words. Three words were selected that seemed to indicate a positive attitude, "honey," "thanks," and "dear." Three were neutral, "maybe," "really," and "oh," and three were negative, "don't," "brute," and "terrible."

Two female speakers were employed to read each of the nine words with each of the three tones, positive, neutral, or disliking of an imaginary addressee. These were recorded on tape which was then listened to by 30 University of California undergraduates.

They were instructed to imagine that each word was being said by one person to another and to judge what the speaker's attitude was towards the imaginary recipient. One-third were told to ignore the information conveyed by the meaning of the words and to pay attention only to the tone. Another third were told to ignore the tone and pay attitude only to the meaning of the words. The last third were told to utilize both the tone and the content.

The findings were that the independent effects of tone, overall, were stronger than the independent effects of content. I should think so! After all, the words allowed were very limited while the tones allowed were unlimited as long as certain feelings were being demonstrated. But, after all, Mehrabian's main interest is in non-verbal types of communication. However, in fairness, it was mentioned in the discussion that the methodology used failed to solve the problem for which it was intended. An alternative methodology could have employed written communication for assessing the independent effects of content and electronically filtered speech (with the content rendered incomprehensible) for assessing the independent effects of tone. I don't know if an alternative experiment like that was ever carried out.

After commenting on some of the methodological problems, they do go on to say that the results indicate that judgments of attitude from inconsistent messages involving single words spoken with intonation are primarily based on the attitude carried in the tonal component. The use of single words is a long way away from normal communications, don't you think? In fact, they admit that their findings can only be safely extended to situations in which no additional information about the communicator-addressee relationship is available. This seems to relegate it to the realm of tightly controlled laboratory-pure experimentation only.

I would invite all of you readers to examine not only Mehrabian's books, but also his articles in the professional journals which go into more detail concerning his experiments. If enough of us carefully analyze the available data, perhaps we can reinterpret the results in a more useful, meaningful, and workable way than we have in the past.

Time For Accuracy

If we continue to disseminate erroneous information such as the 7-38-55 myth, I feel we are doing a grave disservice not only to the NLP community, but to the public in general. We could do a great service by helping the public realize that the words they use on themselves as well a on others are extremely important in determining the effectiveness and longevity of relationships, the strength of personal self-esteem, and a whole host of other psychological physiological phenomena.

Words and language are probably the primary motivation factors for human beings and they can be enhanced by proper congruent tonality and body language. They can also be somewhat diminished by incongruencies which then often show up as confusion and bewilderment in relationship situations. For example, think how often some battered women have desperately believed the words of their batterers despite overwhelming incongruent behavior. "He said he was really going to change this time."

Think of your own personal experiences in close relationships that have gone sour. Haven't you also

hoped and waited for change that would transform incongruent communication signals into congruent ones? Especially before NLP training? Haven't most of us, at some time, hopelessly clung to our own inaccurate interpretation of another's actions hoping for a miracle that would once again make everything whole and comfortable just like we thought it used to be? And what was the total affect of the spoken word at those times? Did the words really have only a 7% influence on our hopes and desires? Not likely. Given the emotional impact of prior experience and beliefs, our memories are not about to logically reduce the words of a loved one, or former loved one, to such an insignificant role instantaneously.

Such impersonal and coldly analytical reactions are probably destined to remain in the safety aloof confines of the experimental laboratory with its pretend situations and imaginary interactions. Perhaps we could benefit from a re-assessment of old acquired beliefs in the glaring light of real life relationship reactions and perceptions.

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META-STATES®

- *Definition:* A state about another state as in joyful about learning, playful about being serious, curious about anger, calm about fear. The thoughts-and-feelings about other thoughts-and-feelings as mind reflects back onto itself and its products.

Kinds of States:

1) Primary states: Comprised of primary emotions like fear, anger, joy, relaxed, tense, pleasure, pain, etc. and involve thoughts directed outward to the things "out there."

2) Meta-states: The higher level structures like fear of fear, anger at fear, shame about being embarrassed, esteem of self, etc. In these states, your self-reflexivity relates (not to the world), but to yourself, to your thoughts, feelings, or to some abstract conceptual state.

3) Gestalt states: The emergent properties from layering mind repeatedly with other states which gives rise to a new neuro-semantic *system*, an emergent state that's "more than the sum of the parts" such as courage, self-efficacy, resilience, and seeing opportunities.

Meta-State Factors:

- *Frames:* Meta-States describes higher *frames-of-references* which we set these up and use to create stable structures (i.e., beliefs, values, understandings, etc.).
- *Reflexivity:* You never just think. As soon as you think or feel—you then experience thoughts and feelings *about* that first thought, then other thoughts-and-feelings about that thought, and so on. Your self-reflective consciousness works as an "infinite regress" to recursively iterate.
- *Layering:* You layer states onto states to create higher levels of awareness. In layering thinking-and-feeling, you put one state in a higher or *meta* (above, beyond) position to the second. This creates a "*logical type" or "logical level*."
- *Psycho-Logics:* A special kind of internal logic arises from layering of states. When you *transcend* from one state (say, anger or joy) to another state (say, calmness or respect) you set the second state as a frame over the first and *include* it inside it. This gives "calm anger," respectful joy, joyful learning, etc. It makes the first state a member of the class of the second.
- *Non-Linear:* It's not logical in a linear or external way, yet it is *psycho–logical.* Internally when you put a state like anger or fear inside another state (calmness, respect, gentleness, courage, etc.), you change the internal logic of our nervous system and person. You create "logical levels." When you put one state in a "logical" relationship to another state so that one is at a higher *level* then the higher one is *about* the other. This *about-relationship* establishes the "logic."
- *Self-Organizing:* There are no such "things" as logical levels. They do not exist "out there." But only in the mind as how you represent categories and levels. With this logical typing or leveling, the effect of each level is to *organize and control the information on the level below it*. In logical levels each level is progressively more psychologically encompassing and impactful.
- *Coalescing:* By *repetition and habituation* higher frames or states *coalesce* into the lower states. The higher thoughts-and-feelings soak down into them to *qualify* or texture the lower state.

The Basic Meta-Stating Pattern:

1) Awareness of primary state to texture and make more resourceful.
2) Access and anchor a resource state
3) Amplify that resource state
4) Apply resource to another state
5) Analyze the ecology and quality
6) Appropriate to one's future and specific contexts
7)Accelerate in your behavior

NEURO-SEMANTICS®

- *Definition: Performing* (neurology) great *meanings* (semantics) and creating more robust meanings for our performances.

Neuro-Semantic Factors:

- *Emotions:* When something *means* something to you—you *feel* it in your body. The meanings show up as "emotions." The meanings take the form of values, ideas, beliefs, understandings, paradigms, mental models, frames, etc.

- *Meaning-Making:* Neuro-Semantics is a model of how you make meaning through evaluating experiences, events, words, etc. It's a model of how you then live in the World or Matrix of Meaning that you construct and inherit.

- *Matrix as Frames of Meaning:* Neuro-Semantics describes the frames of reference you use as we move through life and the frames of meaning that you construct. It creates the Matrix of Frames in which we live and from which you operate.

- *Semantic Reactions:* The reactions that occur which indicate our semantic structures.

- *Generative Neuro-Semantics:* Building up new gestalt states which offer new experiences which are more than the sum of the parts.

- *Systemic:* The meta-state structure of Neuro-Semantics involves a different kind of thinking as it shifts from linear to non-linear thinking. Systemic thinking involves *reflexivity, recursiveness, and spiral thinking.* It means following feedback and feed forward loops around the loops of the fluid Matrix.

Neuro-Semantic Models:

- The first model of Neuro-Semantics is the *Meta-States Model* which maps your reflexivity, self-reflexive consciousness, and which describes the layering of states upon states to create your matrix of frames and higher levels of mind and perception.

- The *Mind-Lines Model* came next as a model for conversational reframing to transform meaning.

- The *Frame Games Model* detects, diagnoses, and transforms the inner game of our frames so that we can take our outer games of our performances to new levels of expertise.

- The *Matrix Model* provides a systemic and unifying model of all the patterns and processes in NLP and NS, offering 3 process matrices from Cognitive psychology and five content matrices from Developmental psychology as a diagnostic and modeling tool.

- The *Axes of Change* model maps the process of change and transformation using 4 meta-programs as axes for the dance of change.

- The *Neuro-Semantic Self-Actualization model* includes the *Self-Actualization Quadrants* which enables us to diagnose the relationship between meaning and performance and to use the quadrants to recognize that we all *perform meaning* and hence experience neuro-semantic states.

- The *Matrix of Self-Actualization* model offers a practical way to coach self-actualization.

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L. Michael Hall is a visionary leader in the field of NLP and Neuro-Semantics, and a modeler of human excellence. Searching out areas of human excellence, he models the structure of that expertise and then turns that information into models, patterns, training manuals, and books. With his several businesses, Michael is also an entrepreneur and an international trainer.

His doctorate is in the Cognitive-Behavioral sciences from Union Institute University. For two decades he worked as a psychotherapist in Colorado. When he found NLP in 1986, he studied and then worked with Richard Bandler. Later when studying and modeling resilience, he developed the Meta-States Model (1994) that launched the field of Neuro-Semantics. He co-created the *International Society of Neuro-Semantics* (ISNS) with Dr. Bob Bodenhamer. Learning the structure of writing, he began writing and has written more than 40 books, many best sellers in the field of NLP.

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